



SHOCKING INCIDENT

Lawyer throws papers at CJI-led Bench

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NEW LEGISLATION

Discussions continue on proposed nuclear Bill

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VIOLENT EPISODE

BJP MP attacked in Bengal, hospitalised

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INDIA'S DEVELOPMENT

Criticism of the judiciary

Courts only mirror the failures that mire governance

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PERFECT DAY

Brits, Luus and Mlaba star in SA's big win

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Practising restraint

Mary Brunkow, Fred Ramsdell, and Shimon Sakaguchi won the 2025 Nobel Prize for medicine/physiology for revealing how the body restrains its own defences to stay healthy



The immune system must distinguish the self from invaders to avoid attacking the body itself

Shimon Sakaguchi discovered regulatory T-cells that calm immune reactions and preserve self-tolerance

Mary Brunkow and Fred Ramsdell traced the scurvy mouse's fatal autoimmunity to a faulty Foxp3 gene

They linked FOXP3 mutations to human IPEX syndrome, proving its vital role in tolerance

Together, their work revealed FOXP3 controls regulatory T-cell development and prevents immune 'mutiny'

Today, the findings guide new therapies for autoimmune disease, cancer, and transplantation

Mary Brunkow

Fred Ramsdell

Shimon Sakaguchi

Image Credit: Nobel Prize Outreach

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11 T.N. fishers hurt in mid-sea attacks

The Hindu Bureau
TIRUCHI

In separate incidents, two groups comprising 11 fishermen from Tamil Nadu's Nagapattinam district sustained injuries after they were allegedly attacked mid-sea by unidentified persons suspected to be from Sri Lanka. The incidents occurred east of Kodiyakarai on Sunday night. Coastal Security Group (CSG) sources said six fish-

ermen from Nambiyar Nagar in the district had set sail on a fibre boat around 2 p.m. They were fishing east of Kodiyakarai around 8 p.m. when eight persons, suspected to be Sri Lankan nationals, arrived on two boats and boarded the fishermen's boat. The group allegedly attacked the fishermen and robbed them, CSG sources said. They returned to the shore in the early hours of Monday and were admit-

ted to the Government Medical College Hospital in Nagapattinam. In the second incident, five fishermen who ventured into the sea on Sunday afternoon were allegedly attacked by a group suspected to be from Sri Lanka. One of them was taken to Thanjavur for treatment, while the others are undergoing treatment at the Government Medical College Hospital in Nagapattinam, sources said.

Consider sharing Wangchuk's detention grounds with wife, top court tells Centre

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Monday orally asked the Centre to consider sharing the grounds of preventive detention of climate activist Sonam Wangchuk with his wife, Gitanjali Angmo, even as the Centre said her *habeas corpus* plea was a ruse to create an “emotive atmosphere”. Mr. Wangchuk was detained under the National Security Act (NSA), 1980 following violent protests in Leh on September 24. Dr. Angmo had asked the top court to direct the

Gitanjali Angmo in New Delhi. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

detaining authorities to produce Mr. Wangchuk in court. She submitted that it had been 10 days since he was reported to be detained at Jodhpur in Rajasthan on September 26. There was no informa-

tion about the grounds of his detention or the state of his health, she added. Issuing notice to the Centre and the Ladakh administration, a Bench of Justices Aravind Kumar and N.V. Anjaria said “something has been done” for now. It posted the case for hearing on October 14. The Bench, in its short order dictated in court after a brief hearing, put the ball in the court of the Centre and other authorities concerned to decide whether or not to share the grounds of preventive detention with Dr. Angmo. The court drew the at-

tention of senior advocate Kapil Sibal, appearing for Dr. Angmo, to Section 8 of the NSA. The provision requires the grounds of detention to be communicated only to Mr. Wangchuk. Solicitor-General Tushar Mehta, appearing for the Centre and the Ladakh administration, said the authorities had shared the grounds with Mr. Wangchuk immediately and there was no further obligation under the NSA to share them with his wife. Dr. Angmo has argued the detention is both mala fide and designed to suppress democratic dissent.

Maritime drills

Dramatic display: The Indian Coast Guard and Navy conducting the exercise NATPOLREX-X off the Chennai coast on Monday to tackle marine oil spill emergencies and strengthen India's preparedness. B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

Six patients killed in massive fire at Jaipur hospital

Mohammed Iqbal
JAIPUR

Six patients were killed in a massive fire in an intensive care unit (ICU) at the trauma centre of Sawai Man Singh Government Hospital on Sunday night. Two women and four men in the neurosurgery ICU died of burns and suffocation. The fire erupted in the ICU's storage section from a suspected short circuit. The hospital is the biggest government-run health facility in Rajasthan. The government has set up a high-level committee to probe the cause of the fire. **Officials sacked** The State government removed trauma centre in-charge Anurag Dhakad and Hospital Superintendent Sushil Bhati from their posts, and suspended executive engineer Mukesh Singhal on Monday evening, holding them responsible for the mishap.

Patients being wheeled out by staff and family members after a fire broke out at Sawai Man Singh Hospital, Jaipur, on Sunday night. PTI

The tender for S.K. Electric Company - the agency hired for fire safety - was cancelled and instructions were given for registering an FIR against it. The deceased were identified as Pintu Gujjar, 25, from Sikar; Dilip, 40, and Bahadur, 40, from Jaipur; and Shri Nath, 54, Rukmani Kaur, 55, and Kumsa, 54, from Bharatpur. The fire erupted on the second floor of the trauma

centre opposite the main hospital building on Tonk Road. Mr. Dhakad said 11 patients were being treated in the neurosurgery ICU and 14 in a second ICU on the same floor. Those in the second ICU were shifted to safer places. Thick smoke spread rapidly in the trauma centre, triggering panic. Hospital staff and family members of patients wheeled them out of the building. Rukmani Kaur's sons

Fire tenders rushed to the spot and broke a window on the opposite side to start extinguishing the fire. It was contained in about two hours. The police could not enter the building immediately because of the smoke.

Kin stage protest Relatives of the victims staged a protest outside the hospital on Monday, raising slogans against the administration and the State government. They alleged negligence by the hospital staff and said the trauma centre had safety lapses and no equipment to douse the flames. “We raised a warning about the smoke 20 minutes earlier, but no one responded. All doctors and staff ran away when the fire broke out,” Dashrath Gujjar, brother of Pintu Gujjar, said when Minister for Home Jawahar Singh Bedham visited the site. Rukmani Kaur's sons

Sheru Singh and Joginder Singh said they raised an alarm at 11.15 p.m. when they noticed sparks and smoke, but the hospital staff ignored the alert. “The plaster began to melt. When the smoke began to spread, the staff fled. We were not allowed to go inside the ICU, but Sheru managed to bring out our mother... She did not survive,” Mr. Joginder said. The State government constituted a high-level investigation committee, while a forensic team of the Rajasthan police collected samples from the site. The six-member committee will be headed by Medical Education Commissioner Iqbal Khan. The bodies of the deceased will be handed over to their families after post-mortem, officials said. Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Rajasthan Chief Minister Bhajan Lal Sharma expressed grief over the tragedy.

IMA opposes M.P. doctor's arrest in cough syrup case

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Indian Medical Association (IMA) on Monday raised strong objections to the arrest of a doctor in Madhya Pradesh in connection with the contaminated cough syrup case, in which over 10 children have died in the State. Calling the arrest “an indiscriminate action against a doctor”, the IMA said this was a clear-cut case of a spurious drug as defined in Section 17B of the Drugs and Cosmetics Act. **‘Legal illiteracy’** The association said the action against the doctor was a “classic example of legal illiteracy of the officials and the police”. “The IMA demands immediate action against the actual culprits and adequate compensation for the

Officials sealing the office of a firm that allegedly supplied a contaminated cough syrup, in Jabalpur on Sunday. PTI

affected families and the doctor who is a victim of defamation,” it said. The association said the FIR was lodged at the Parasia police station on Saturday, naming a paediatric specialist posted at a Community Health Centre, along with the directors of M/s Sresan Pharmaceuticals, Tamil Nadu, the manufacturers of the cough syrup in which contamination has been detected.

“The arrest of the doctor in haste shows an attempt to divert the attention of the people from the faults of regulatory bodies and the pharmaceutical company,” the IMA said. It added that “the prescribing doctor has no way of knowing whether a medicine is contaminated until adverse outcomes are reported among patients who have taken it”. Regulation must, therefore, be made foolproof to prevent such tragedies, the association said. Many people purchase cough syrups over the counter without a doctor's prescription, which means far more children consume them than medically necessary. In most cases, coughs and colds resolve on their own without any syrup, it said. **3 OFFICIALS SUSPENDED** » PAGE 12

A ND-NDE

INBRIEF



CM announces financial aid for sanitation workers in U.P.

Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath announced on Monday that the State government will directly transfer ₹16,000 to ₹20,000 as aid to the bank accounts of sanitation workers, according to a statement. The Chief Minister made the announcement during the ‘Swachhata Mitra Samman’ ceremony at Saroj Palace in Piplani Katra. He honoured sanitation workers who contributed significantly during the ‘Swachhata Hi Seva Pakhwada’. He announced that Tuesday will be a public holiday on the occasion of Valmiki Jayanti. PTI

Zubeen death: barring Kalita, 7 others yet to respond to SIT

Assam Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma on Monday said barring one, seven others present with singer Zubeen Garg during his last moments in Singapore were yet to respond to the summons issued by the SIT formed to probe the case. Mr. Sarma said Rupkamal Kalita, who was present on the yacht when Garg died while swimming in the sea, has responded to the summons. He will come to Guwahati on Tuesday, the CM said. However, the seven others have not said anything about coming to Assam, he said. PTI

J&K removes official over social media gag order

Peerzada Ashiq
SRINAGAR

An official who issued a social media gag order to teachers in north Kashmir, “without the consent of the Education Minister”, was removed from his position by the Jammu and Kashmir government on Monday. “Employees are our own and have the right to express themselves constructively. Such unilateral decisions will not be tolerated. Any official or officer found working against the interests of the common masses will face strict action,” said Minister Sakina Itoo. The officer, Bashir Ahmad Shah - who worked as in-charge chief education officer, Baramulla - has now been attached to the Directorate of School Education, Kashmir, pending an inquiry, an official communicate stated.

Senthilbalaji case: SC orally moots shifting trial of former T.N. Minister to another State

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Monday orally mooted transferring the cash-for-jobs scam case involving former Tamil Nadu Minister V. Senthilbalaji, who is facing money laundering charges, to another State or to Delhi. A Bench of Justices Surya Kant and Joymalya Bagchi said transferring the case to a place outside Tamil Nadu and setting up a dedicated court to hear it on a day-to-day basis would even benefit Mr. Senthilbalaji. “If he is found innocent, he can go back and resume his public life and hold positions in government,” Justice Kant addressed senior advocates A.M. Singhvi and Amit Anand Tiwari, appearing for Tamil Nadu.



The Bench said transferring the case to a place outside Tamil Nadu would even benefit V. Senthilbalaji. FILE PHOTO

Both senior counsel vehemently opposed the suggestion, saying it would show the State’s judiciary in a bad light.

‘Charged atmosphere’ However, Justice Kant reasoned that during the trial of a sensitive case, the atmosphere in the home State would usually suffer

from a “charged atmosphere”, with the Opposition parties accusing the government of favouritism, delay, and bias. “Allegations are bound to come every day. If the trial is started at any other place, witnesses can depose online. We can direct a dedicated court to take up the case on a day-to-day basis. This gentleman, who is a public figure, if he is finally found to be falsely accused, could go on to resume his public position,” Justice Kant observed orally. Mr. Singhvi said though the suggestion from the Bench was *bonafide*, it could be misconstrued in the media. The public would misunderstand that the court had lost faith in the judiciary of Tamil Nadu. He sought time to respond to the suggestion.

Rajasthan women break social barriers through filmmaking

Alisha Dutta
AJMER

Every morning, a quiet revolution unfolds inside a modest two-storey building in Rajasthan’s Ajmer. Women of all ages, once bound by the shackles of child marriage, now walk into the office of the Mahila Jan Adhikar Samiti (MJAS), an NGO dedicated to empowering women and girls. Some pick up cameras and head out to shoot, while others settle in front of computer screens to edit their films. Together, they are scripting new futures - one frame at a time. At the office, over 30 women are learning the craft of filmmaking and editing. Many are the first in their families to hold a camera and turn the lens on the world they inhabit. The NGO - founded in 1997 and based in Ajmer, Tonk, and Bhilwara districts of Rajasthan - emerged from grassroots movements led by women

who fought for land rights and against caste discrimination, child marriage, and honour killings. Today, it has a strong presence in several blocks across the three districts, focusing on digital literacy, leadership programmes, and awareness initiatives on gender equality and domestic violence. MJAS has built deep connections with the women in these areas, providing them with a platform to voice their concerns and drive positive change in their lives and communities. The filmmaking course is part of MJAS’s efforts to empower rural women with skills for the digital age. The course, initially taught by Anhad Films, has successfully transitioned to a peer-led model, where trained women now teach and mentor others. Inside the edit room, Manju Rawat, 19, concentrates on her desktop. Clips of a film she is editing appear on the screen. When



Frames of change: Women learning filmmaking at the office of the Mahila Jan Adhikar Samiti in Ajmer. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

she joined the NGO in 2023, her only goal was to gain digital literacy. However, when it decided to teach filmmaking, including lessons in scripting, interviewing, and camera work, it piqued her interest. “When I first stepped out of my house to learn how to use a computer, everyone laughed at me. My family and neighbours would say, ‘Dekho kaise daud rahi hai idhar udhar (See how she is running around).’ But I chose not to

get affected,” she recalls. Hailing from a conservative family that fixed her marriage to a 20-year-old when she was just four, Ms. Rawat persisted and kept walking daily to the NGO’s office in Ajmer to hone her skills. Her early films turned the camera towards women like herself, married off at a young age but striving for more. “I was rejected by my in-laws on the day of my *gauna* (consummation of marriage) due to my short height, but some

Kerala tables Malayalam Language Bill in House to conserve linguistic rights

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

The Left Democratic Front (LDF) government tabled the Malayalam Language Bill, 2025 in the Assembly on Monday. Law Minister P. Rajeeve said the Bill aims to enshrine the Malayalam language at the heart of official communications in the State. The draft law also seeks to render it the legal language in courts trying lesser offences under the respective district and sessions courts, he said. Mr. Rajeeve said the Bill also seeks to protect the rights of linguistic minorities, including citizens who consider Tamil, Kannada, Tulu, and Kongu their mother tongues. “The Bill conserves their right to use their respective languages or English for their communications with the government,” he added.



He said the Bill seeks to render Malayalam as Kerala’s sole official language. The State now recognises English and Malayalam as official languages. The draft law also proposes to make Malayalam the first language in schools. Creation of body The Bill proposes the creation of a Malayalam Language Development Directorate under the aegis of the Official Language Wing for Personnel and Administrative Reforms. The Law Minister said the Bill renders Malayalam the official language of ordinances promulgated by the Kerala Governor, Bills introduced in the Assembly, Acts passed by the legislature, and also rules, orders, regulations, and bylaws of the government, with English translations provided. He said earlier versions of the Bill, aimed at preserving, nurturing, and developing Malayalam

against the backdrop of the global march of foreign languages, chiefly English, failed to receive gubernatorial and presidential assent. He said the Centre had raised objections regarding provisions concerned with the rights of linguistic minorities, trilingual education in compliance with the national curriculum, and the Right to Education Act, 2009. Mr. Rajeeve said the Bill seeks to rectify anomalies while safeguarding and promoting the Malayalam language and culture. He blamed the Opposition United Democratic Front (UDF) for “irresponsibly disrupting” the House during crucial legislative business. He noted that “clueless and subject-starved” UDF members made a mockery of themselves by walking out at the end of adjournment debates.

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of my peers had started living with their in-laws. I wanted them to talk about their joys, struggles, and dreams for their children.” Ms. Rawat and her sister, Sanju, 19, have shot a film on the lives of daily wage workers of Ajesar village in Ajmer. Across the room sits Bhagwati Devi, 24, who was married at 15 and travels nearly 30 km every day from her village, Bhawani, to Ajmer. “My 17-year-old sister and I were married off at the same *mandap* (marriage venue) to save money. When I said I wanted to learn filmmaking, my in-laws did not support me,” she says. Today, Ms. Devi has made films on the practice of wearing the *ghoonghat* (veil) and on the Ghumanu tribe, a nomadic community that is excluded from welfare schemes due to a lack of documents. All women pursuing the course have made at least one film, but say they often

face resistance from men in the field. Early this year, Santra Chaurasia, 23, Ms. Devi, and two others were hired to film a wedding in Kishangarh - their first professional project. While the women were welcoming and happy to see them filming, “men kept giving us instructions, refusing to take us seriously”, Ms. Chaurasia recalls. ‘Collective victory’ Despite many such challenges, solidarity keeps them going. “When someone misses classes, we visit their home to check on them. We want to make sure no one drops out because of family pressure,” says 22-year-old Mary. They are all eager to encourage more women to step out of their homes. “Earlier, I was the only one in my colony to leave home to learn editing. Now, several women have joined me. This is our collective victory,” says Namira Banu, a 21-year-old trainer.

Canine attacks artiste during street play against dog menace

The Hindu Bureau
KANNUR

In an ironic twist, a street play against stray dog menace turned nasty when an artiste was bitten by a dog during the performance at Mayyil Kandankai in Kerala’s Kannur district on Sunday night. The incident occurred around 8 p.m. during the one-act play, *Pekkolam*, staged by the Krishnapillai Library at Kandakaiparamba. Theatre activist P. Radhakrishnan, a native of Kandakai, sustained injuries to his hands and legs after being attacked by a dog that entered the stage. Sound effect According to eyewitnesses, the attack happened when a barking sound effect was played through the microphone, triggering a pack of



A stray dog attacking an artiste during a street play in Kannur, Kerala. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

dogs nearby. Mistaking it for part of the act, the audience initially continued watching until organisers rushed to Mr. Radhakrishnan’s aid. He was later admitted to the Kannur Government Medical College Hospital for treatment. The incident has sparked renewed concern over the growing stray dog menace.

भारत के निवेश एवं मजदूरीकार्यक्रम का कार्यालय
Office of the Comptroller and Auditor General of India
9 डीन डयाल उपधिया मार्ग, नई दिल्ली - 110 124
9 Deen Dayal Upadhyaya Marg, New Delhi - 110124

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Engagement of Young Professionals

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05.11.2025 है। इसका अधिकार जानकारी के लिए www.cag.gov.in पर जाएं।

The office of the CAG of India is engaging Young Professionals. Last date for receipt of applications is 05.11.2025. For more details, please visit www.cag.gov.in. Alternatively, you may scan the following QR code for the same.



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CBC-51101/11/0007/2526

GOVERNMENT OF JAMMU AND KASHMIR
DIRECTORATE OF HORTICULTURE, KASHMIR
Rajbagh, Srinagar, Opposite Presentation Convent School -190008
TELEFAX: 01943100919/01943100920 Email: horti-kashmir@jk.gov.in
website: <http://hortikashmir.gov.in>

Tender for Import of Rootstocks of different fruit crops under the Project
"Production of Designer Plants for Promotion of High-Density Plantation
and Rejuvenation of Orchards" for Public Sector Nurseries under Holistic
Agriculture Development Program (HADP)
e-NIT No.- 70 of 2025Date: 29-09-2025
(Tender ID: 2025_HPD_290188_1)

For and on behalf of Hon'ble Lieutenant Governor, Union Territory of Jammu & Kashmir, Director Horticulture, Kashmir invites e-Tenders in two cover bid system (Technical bid-1 and Financial bid-2) for Import of Rootstocks of different fruit crops under the Project "Production of Designer Plants for Promotion of High-Density Plantation and Rejuvenation of Orchards" for Public Sector Nurseries under Holistic Agriculture Development Program (HADP).
The bidding documents consisting of qualifying information, eligibility criteria, specifications, bill of quantities (B.O.Q), set of terms and conditions of contract and other details can be seen/downloaded from the e-procurement website www.jktenders.gov.in as per schedule of dates given below.

Date of issue of Tender Notice	29/09/2025
Date of downloading of bidding documents	29/09/2025
Bid submission start date	04/10/2025
Bid submission end date	22/10/2025
Date and time of opening of technical bids (online)	23/10/2025

Instructions for bidders regarding e-tendering process:
1. Bidders are advised to download bids submission manual from the "Downloads option as well as from Bidders Manual kit" on the website www.jktenders.gov.in to acquaint themselves with bid submission process.
2. To participate in bidding process, bidder has to get a Digital Signature Certificate (DSC), as per Information Technology ACT-2000. Bidders can get Digital Certificate from an approved vendor.
3. The bidder must submit complete bids online in electronic format with a digital signature. Bidders must ensure to upload scanned copies of all necessary documents with the technical bid. However, a copy of the technical bid as uploaded and a receipt of Rs. 1000/- as Tender cost alongwith Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) amounting to Rs. 10,00 lacs (Ten Lacs only) both pledged in favour of Accounts Officer, Directorate of Horticulture, Kashmir shall be submitted in physical form by registered post/through courier on or before the date specified above.
4. Bidders must ensure to upload scanned copy of all necessary documents with the technical bid.
5. The department will not be responsible for delay in online submission due to any reason.

Table	
Price of bidding document (non-refundable) Inclusive of all taxes	Rs. 1000/- as cost of the tender document shall be furnished in shape of e-challan or simply uploading a copy of necessary treasury challan/receipt.
Place of opening of bids (online)	Directorate of Horticulture, Kashmir Rajbagh, Srinagar
Address of Communications	CHAIRMAN PURCHASE COMMITTEE Directorate of Horticulture, Kashmir Rajbagh, Srinagar E-mail- dhk-kashmir@jk.gov.in

Sd/-
(Vikas Anand)
Director
Horticulture Kashmir

DIPK-6874/25

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LEGAL NOTICE

ECA No. 27/2023
IN THE COURT OF PRINCIPAL SENIOR CIVIL JUDGE AND CJM, DHARWAD AT : DHARWAD
Petitioners: 1) Smt. Drakshayani W/o Nagappa Gulashetti and others, R/o. Narendra Village, Tq : Dist: Dharwad
V/S
Respondents: 1) Babu S/o. B.M. Yaligar and Others, Age: 50 years, Occ : Coolie, R/o: Sannakeri, Yallapur Oni, Near Gowshala, Bankapur Chowk, Hubballi - 580020, Dist: Dharwad and others
UNDER ORDER V RULE 20(A) OF CIVIL PROCEDURE CODE SUMMONS TO RESPONDENT No. 3
Jaikam, Age: 40 years, Occ: POP Contract Business, R/o: Bibpur NUH House No. 182, Haryana-122107.
Whereas petitioners have filed above said petition for grant of compensation on account of death of Nagappa S/o Siddappa Gulashetti,
Therefore, you are hereby directed to appear in person or through your counsel before this Honble court on 19/11/2025 at 11:00 a.m. failing which the matter will be proceeded further in your absence.
Given under my hand and seal of this Court on this the 04th day of October 2025
Place : Dharwad,
Date: 04-10-2025
By Order of the Court
Sd/- Shirastedar, Principal Senior Civil Judge And CJM, Dharwad
Sd/- (B.B. Rayaraddi)
Advocate, Dharwad

LEGAL NOTICE
In the court of the II Additional District Judge, Thanjavur (Tamil Nadu)
O.S.No. 249 Of 2023
Husmudeen Ansari .. Plaintiff
Vs
2. T.Juvaiha Begam, W/O.Thanveer Ahmed, Dhammarvar Village, Tammar Bar (Post), Kashiya Taluk, Kashiya. PS, Kushi Nagar Dt, Uthar Pradesh State.
3. A.Rashitha Begam, W/O.Ashik Ali Ansari, Boikuntha Poorkothai Village, Thuthaki Post, Thomkukirai Tk, Bihampoor, PS, Kushi Nagar District. Uthar Pradesh Defendants
Notice
Please take this notice that above said defendants 2 and 3 please appear before this Hon'ble court on. 16.10.2025 at 10-00 AM in the above said Suit either in person or through your counsel, failing which the matter would be decided in your absence.
G.Sudhakar, BA.,BL., Advocate for Plaintiff Thanjavur (Tamil Nadu)

SITUATION VACANT

GENERAL
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A Newspaper exclusively curated for School Students

"WHISPERS ON PAPERS" CELEBRATED


Delhi Public School Ghaziabad, Vasundhara, celebrated their Annual Wing Production "Whispers on Papers" with creativity and cultural vibrancy. The programme opened with the Lighting of the Lamp and a soulful Sufi invocation, followed by a thematic presentation tracing the evolution of letters from handwritten notes to digital communication. Students showcased world cultures through captivating dances from China, Russia, Spain, and Africa. Chief Guest Mr. Anindya Chakravorty inspired learners with his address, while Principal Dr. Vinod Kumar motivated them towards excellence. The event concluded with a Vote of Thanks and heartfelt appreciation.

PROUD ACHIEVEMENTS


Gurukul The School students brought glory to the nation by winning multiple medals and the Best Project Award at the International Olympiad on Climate Change and Environmental Issues held in Russia. Representing Team India, they secured the Silver Medal in team standings, while Kausthubh Gopalan and Avni Garg won Gold, Adhya Shrama claimed Silver, and Jahnavi Mittal earned Bronze. Their project was acclaimed globally for its innovation and impact. The achievement reflects Gurukul's commitment to nurturing globally responsible learners equipped to address environmental and sustainability challenges through academic excellence and leadership.

HOMERTON'S CONCLAVE OF VISIONARY LEADERS


Homerton Grammar School, Faridabad, successfully hosted "Homerton's Conclave of Visionary Leaders – Together for Tomorrow," a pioneering workshop that united over 65 play school leaders to discuss implementing NEP 2020 in early childhood education. Conducted by renowned educationist Dr. Akshita Bahuguna, the session focused on inclusive learning, pedagogical innovation, and leadership transformation. The event concluded with a felicitation ceremony for participating schools, led by the school's leadership team. This landmark initiative positioned Homerton Grammar School as a frontrunner in fostering collaboration and strengthening early education leadership across Faridabad.

For Subscription related queries, please contact Kapil Nagar:
Handphone: +91 9810089457/Email: kapil.nagar@thehindu.co.in

GOVERNMENT OF ASSAM
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER: PWD: H&E: ASSAM: CHANDMARI: GUWAHATI-3.
No. CE/TB-IV(H&E)/48/2025/23
PRESS NOTICE (RE-TENDER)
The Chief Engineer, P.W.D. Building (Health & Education), Assam, Chandmari, Guwahati-3 on behalf of the Governor of Assam, again invites fresh Bids from eligible firms / contractors of repute having experience in similar nature of work, for the following works.
Details of the bid may be seen at e-procurement website i.e. www.assamtenders.gov.in.
The bidders must be enrolled with e-tendering web-portal www.assamtenders.gov.in.
All terms and conditions will be as per the Bidding Documents. The Press Notice will be a part of the Bidding Documents.

Sl. No.	Name of work	Bid Value (Rs in Lakh)	Completion Period	Bid Security	Cost of Bid
1	Balance work for the Construction of Model Secondary School in Tea Garden Areas of Assam under RIDF- XXVIII at Arkatiapur TE, Dist: Cachar	Rs. 282.36306	210 days (Seven months)	2% of Bid value for General, 1% of Bid Value for Reserve category	Rs. 5650.00

The Bid price may vary at the time of detail tendering for which no claim will be admissible.

Chief Engineer, P.W.D., (Health & Education)
Assam, Chandmari, Guwahati-3
DIPR /C/HIND/ 475/ 7-Oct-25

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APPLICATION FOR VENDOR REGISTRATION in BYPL Date: 07.10.2025

Applications are invited for "new vendor registration and revalidation of existing vendor registration" on BSES portal <https://www.bsesdelhi.com/web/bypl/bypl-tenders> as on or before 28.10.2025. Vendors who have already applied in our portal need not to resubmit their application.

Head (Contracts & Materials)

Regd.Off: BSES Yamuna Power Ltd, Shakti Kiran Building, Karkardooma, Delhi-110032 | CIN: U40109DL2001PLC111525
Website: www.bsesdelhi.com

**आईआरईएल (इंडिया) लिमिटेड**
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(Formerly Indian Rare Earths Limited)
Rare Earths Division, Kochi, Kerala, email:purchase-red@irel.co.in
CIN:U15100MH1950GO1008187
An ISO 9001:2015, ISO 14001:2015 & ISO 45001:2018 Company

TENDER NOTICE
IREL (India) Limited, Rare Earths Division invites tender for the following item/job description:

Item/job description	Availability of Tender in GeM Portal
Transportation(ARC) of Rare Earths Chloride	04.10.2025

For details visit the following websites: gem.gov.in, www.irel.co.in/, tender.information <https://eprocure.gov.in/cppp>
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**POSTGRADUATE INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL EDUCATION & RESEARCH CHANDIGARH**

NOTICE INVITING TENDERS (NIT)
On behalf of Director, PGIMER, Sector 12, Chandigarh 160012, the undersigned invites sealed tender to make Rate Contract and Annual Purchase as per the details shown in the table below. The manufacturer and their authorized dealers/distributors can offer their minimum rates as per terms and conditions contained in the tender form. The sealed tender with Technical Bids & Financial Bids (Price Bids) duly drafted in the name of Director, Postgraduate Institute of Medical Education & Research, Sector 12, Chandigarh 160012, and addressed to Purchase Officer (HPD) may be submitted as per schedule given below:-

S. No.	Tender Enquiry Number & Date	Brief Description of Goods	Amount of Bid Security (EMD) (INR)
1	Proc. Indgn. (HPD)/2025/371 Dated:	Repair and Maintenance of Water Purifiers through Rate Contract for the period of two year, Qty: 400	Rs.70,000/-
Closing date & Time for receipt of Bids		On or before 17.10.2025 at 12:30 P.M	
Date, time and place for opening of technical bids		17.10.2025 at 03:00 P.M at Procurement Branch (HPD), Central Store, 2 nd Floor, Nehru Building, PGIMER, Sector-12, Chandigarh.	

- The bidders may download the tender documents directly from the website of the Institute www.pgimer.edu.in/ or CPP Portal (www.eprocure.gov.in). The bidders should specifically super scribed, "Downloaded from the Institute's website" on the top left corner of the outer envelope containing Technical Bid & Financial Bid separately. The bids submitted by the bidders not following the above procedure will summarily be rejected.
- The Bid Security (EMD) for an amount mentioned in this NIT will have to be deposited & submitted with Technical Bid in the form of an Account Payee Demand Draft/ Banker's Cheque/Deposit at call receipt or an FDR/TDR/Bank Guarantee in original duly pledged in favour of **Postgraduate Institute of Medical Education and Research, Sector-12, Chandigarh** and having its validity for at least **One Year** and issued by a **Scheduled Commercial Bank**. This bid security (EMD) may be attached with the Technical Bid. FDR/TDR issued for less-amount or issued by Banks before the date of floating this NIT shall not be accepted & bids received with such FDR/TDR shall summarily be rejected. Micro Small & Medium Enterprises as also startups as recognized by the department of MSME are exempted for submission of EMD on production of requisite certificate.
- It is the responsibility of the Bidders to ensure that their bids, whether sent CPP Portal or by Regd. Post/Courier / in person, are to be delivered in Procurement Branch (HPD), 2nd Floor, C-Block, Central Store, Sector-12, PGIMER, Chandigarh' & are received by on or before closing date and time stipulated above for receipt of bids, failing which the bids would be considered late bids and will be rejected. The bids dropped in the other branches/departments/Centers of PGIMER, will not be considered as submitted and such bids will be summarily rejected.
- The date and time for opening of the Financial Bids (Price Bids) shall be intimated later after evaluation of the technical bids.
- In the event of any of the above mentioned dates being declared as a holiday/closed day in the PGIMER, Chandigarh, the bids will be received/opened on the next working day at the prescribed venue and time.
- This tender document is non transferable.
- This tender document, consist of pages 1 to 38 pages. The bidder is required to submit a tender acceptance letter on company letter head duly signed and stamped as per annexure V along with other documents as mentioned in Para 37 (1) of the NIT.
- Offers not on the prescribed form shall not be considered.

NOTE: Please visit our website at www.pgimer.edu.in for further details of this tender.

Officer Incharge (HPD),
PGI/RC/Adv./2025/HR-000450
Email: singh.ranbir@pgimer.edu.in
Tele: +91-172-2756479/6

Government of Maharashtra
Water Resources Department
Executive Engineer Mechanical Division, Kolhapur, Sinchan Bhavan, Tarabai Park, Kolhapur
Budgetory Notice No. September / 01 of 2025
Basudev Bhujai LIS Stage-1, 2 and 3, Tal. Radhanagari, Dist. Kolhapur
(for the Estimate Purpose Only)

Budgetory Offers for Design, Manufacturing with quality assurance, Test, Supply, Transport with all Loading and Unloading, Storing, Erection, Testing and Commissioning, of Pumping Machinery as per description given below with allied electro-Mechanical equipments for Basudev Bhujai LIS Stage-1, 2 and 3, Tal. Radhanagari, Dist. Kolhapur Maharashtra) are invited by the Executive Engineer, Mechanical Division, Kolhapur on behalf of Govt of Maharashtra for the Estimation Purpose from the OEM.
Any technical suggestions, relevant literature if any in the matter are welcomed. Considering the nature of work it must be noted while quoting the rate, agency will be totally responsible for the safe design, reliability of system & each activity, parameter suggested & conducted. Before quoting rates agency should visit the site at their own cost, if required.
The rates should be quoted excluding the GST and all taxes & duties/ Cess seperately.
Budgetory offer should reach in the division office on or before 16 October, 2025.

Basudev Bhujai LIS Stage-1, 2 and 3, Tal. Radhanagari, Dist. Kolhapur
Name of Work :- Design, Manufacturing with Quality Assurance, Supply, Erection at site, Testing & Commissioning of Vertical Turbine Pumps with all allied electro- Mechanical equipments as detailed below for Basudev Bhujai LIS Stage-1, 2 and 3, Tal. Radhanagari, Dist. Kolhapur (Maharashtra)

Item No.	Description of Item	Qty.	Unit	Rate/ Unit	Amount
1	2	3	4		
Stage 1					
1	VT Pump Design, manufacture, supply, erection, trail running, performance testing and commissioning of vertical turbine pump at site of works and giving test to full capacity, vertical turbine pumps, non pull out type, complete with strainer, suction bell column assembly, Discharge Tee motor stool, flexible couplings, sole plates, base frame foundation, non reversible-rotation ratchet arrangement etc con-forming to IS: 1710. Suitable for following duties specification and confirming to detailed specifications with tools, tackles etc. 1) Duty point Discharge per pump = 0.805 m3/sec 2) Duty point Head = 127.50 m 3) Pump HP = 1595 HP 5) Max. syn. RPM = 1000 rpm. 6) Column Pipe/Delivery pipe dia. = 700 mm 7) No. of pumps working in parallel = 3 Nos. 8) Self Water lubricated 9) Suspension length = 15.7 m 10) Efficiencies (% Minimum) i) Pump Efficiencies- 86% ii) Bowl Efficiencies - 87% iii) Overall Efficiencies of Pump motor set- 81.70%	3	Nos		
	HT Motor Supply, installation and commissioning at site of works and testing to full capacity, Solid shaft, squirrel cage induction motors CACW type 'F' class installation suitable for operation on voltage mentioned below 3 phase 50 Hz energy efficient with voltage variation of +10 % and frequency variation +3 % suitable for direct coupling with pumps under item No.1 as per latest revision of IS 325, Is 4722 & other Relevant IS specifications. Suitable for following duties, specifications & confirming to detailed specifications. i) Operating volt- 11 kV Minimum ii) (KW) rating of motor 1350 kW iii) RPM = 1000			3	Nos
Stage 2					
1	VT Pump Design, manufacture, supply, erection, trail running, performance testing and commissioning of vertical turbine pump at site of works and giving test to full capacity, vertical turbine pumps, non pull out type, complete with strainer, suction bell column assembly, Discharge Tee motor stool, flexible couplings, sole plates, base frame foundation, non reversible-rotation ratchet arrangement etc con-forming to IS: 1710. Suitable for following duties specification and confirming to detailed specifications with tools, tackles etc. 1) Duty point Discharge per pump = 0.805 m3/sec 2) Duty point Head = 106.74 m. 3) Pump HP = 1335 HP 5) Max. syn. RPM = 1000 rpm. 6) Column Pipe/Delivery pipe dia. = 700 mm 7) No. of pumps working in parallel = 3 Nos. 8) Self Water lubricated 9) Suspension length = 8.7 m 10) Efficiencies (% Minimum) i) Pump Efficiencies- 86% ii) Bowl Efficiencies - 87% iii) Overall Efficiencies of Pump motor set- 81.70%.	3	Nos		
	HT Motor Supply, installation and commissioning at site of works and testing to full capacity, Solid shaft, squirrel cage induction motors CACW type 'F' class installation suitable for operation on voltage mentioned below 3 phase 50 Hz energy efficient with voltage variation of +10 % and frequency variation +3 % suitable for direct coupling with pumps under item No.1 as per latest revision of IS 325, Is 4722 & other Relevant IS specifications. Suitable for following duties, specifications & confirming to detailed specifications. i) Operating volt- 11 kV Minimum ii) (KW) rating of motor 1130 kW iii) RPM 1000			3	Nos
Stage 3					
1	VT Pump Design, manufacture, supply, erection, trail running, performance testing and commissioning of vertical turbine pump at site of works and giving test to full capacity, vertical turbine pumps, non pull out type, complete with strainer, suction bell column assembly, Discharge Tee motor stool, flexible couplings, sole plates, base frame foundation, non reversible-rotation ratchet arrangement etc con-forming to IS: 1710. Suitable for following duties specification and confirming to detailed specifications with tools, tackles etc. 1) Duty point Discharge per pump = 0.611 m3/sec 2) Duty point Head = 58.09 m. 3) Pump HP = 560 HP 5) Max. syn. RPM = 1000 rpm. 6) Column Pipe/Delivery pipe dia. = 600 mm 7) No. of pumps working in parallel = 3 Nos. 8) Self Water lubricated 9) Suspension length = 8.7 m 10) Efficiencies (% Minimum) i) Pump Efficiencies-85% ii) Bowl Efficiencies - 87% iii) Overall Efficiencies of Pump motor set- 80.75%.	3	Nos		
	HT Motor Supply, installation and commissioning at site of works and testing to full capacity, Solid shaft, squirrel cage induction motors CACW type 'F' class installation suitable for operation on voltage mentioned below 3 phase 50 Hz energy efficient with voltage variation of +10% and frequency variation +3 % suitable for direct coupling with pumps under item No.1 as per latest revision of IS 325, Is 4722 & other Relevant IS specifications. Suitable for following duties, specifications & confirming to detailed specifications. i) Operating volt- 6.6 kV Minimum ii) (KW) rating of motor 475 kW iii) RPM 1000			3	Nos
Sub Total Amount Rs. =					
Add Labour welfare cess 1% to Sub Total Amount Rs. =					
Add Insurance 1% to Sub Total Amount Rs. =					
Add GST AS PPLICABLE to Sub Total Amount Rs. =					
Grand Total Amount Rs. =					

The information is required for the purpose of framing the estimate and hence required urgently. This budgetory offer is also available on www.wrd.maharashtra.gov.in
Note- If any queries and any other additional information regarding the above, please contact on below address.
No. MDK/Budgetory Offer/2181/2025 Dt: 29/09/2025
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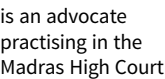


While these measures are good to address the situation in the instant case, what the Indian state must do is have a zero threshold for poor quality drugs. Hawk-like monitoring is necessary, and action when violations are detected. It is criminal to act only when deaths have occurred; that is indefensible. A framework of proven Good Laboratory Practices already exists; what is needed is seriousness in handling every such reported violation, along with regular, surprise inspections of drug batches, with appropriate action taken for every violation. It is important to send the message down the assembly line that the government will not brook any shoddiness or violations that endanger the lives of people.

The Nobel laureates' work has redefined the immune system itself

Today, in autoimmune diseases, experimental treatments aim to expand or stabilise Tregs. Early clinical trials have shown that reinforcing this cell population can mitigate harmful immune activation without broad immunosuppression. In transplantation, engineered Tregs are being infused to improve graft acceptance. In cancer, researchers are exploring selective depletion or reprogramming of tumour-associated Tregs to enhance immunity without triggering autoimmunity. Beyond therapy, the conceptual shift brought on by the laureates' work has redefined the immune system: from an on/off apparatus to a dynamic ecosystem of activation and restraint. That Brunkow and Ramsdell conducted their work within industry also underscores how private sector research can yield significant discoveries. But even now, some immunologists caution against underestimating the field's incremental nature. In a testament to the broader landscape including overlapping layers of control rather than a single molecular pathway, researchers face several obstacles to translating what they know to safe, scalable therapies. Cell-based therapies' high cost has also accentuated inequities in access, creating ethical and policy challenges.

Mr. Sanyal also invokes what he calls the “99-to-1 problem”. In his telling, most of India’s rules and regulations are drafted to guard against the abuse of laws by a small fraction of people – exceptions, which he argues, should be left to the courts to resolve. “Because I do not think it will get sorted out there, the rest of the 99% of laws and rules end up being complicated to address that 1%, feeding back into a spiral,” he says. The



India's judicial system only mirrors the failures that mire the rest of its governance

What Mr. Sanyal's lament also ignores is that

None of this is to deny that the judiciary needs reform. Delays are real, infrastructure is outdated, and accountability mechanisms are weak. But lampooning the system as the “biggest hurdle” to our development only clouds the debate.

India's constitutional democracy is not designed for speed alone. Courts were never meant to be rubber stamps for governance but independent checks on executive power. To weaken them is to chip away at the very foundation of what development in its truest sense ought to mean. The judiciary is not flawless. But if we are serious about reform, we must look beyond distortions on vacations and delays and confront the structural failings that lie elsewhere.

There is no doubt that Israel has achieved remarkable military successes against its enemies in the past 23 months. It has decapitated the leadership of Hamas and its ally Hezbollah in Lebanon, killed thousands of their fighters and inflicted a severe blow to the Iranian military with

Israel's new
defence doctrine
will only make
its citizens
more insecure

Letters emailed to
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Reforming passive euthanasia in India

In June, the U.K.'s House of Commons passed the Terminally Ill Adults (End of Life) Bill, reigniting a global conversation about euthanasia. The proposed law permits physician-assisted dying for mentally competent adults expected to live fewer than six months, subject to medical certification and oversight by a national panel. While it is awaiting approval from the House of Lords, the Bill marks a bold legal and moral step that many western countries have embraced.

While India has recognised passive euthanasia through a series of Supreme Court judgments, it has consciously drawn a line against active euthanasia. Cultural values, institutional capacity, and socio-economic conditions make it unlikely that India will mirror the U.K.'s path. But that does not mean it should remain static.

Practical inaccessibility

Passive euthanasia permits the withdrawal of life-sustaining treatment when it merely prolongs suffering. It is not an act of killing but an allowance for death to take its natural course. Yet, despite legal recognition, procedural requirements, such as advance directives, dual medical board clearance, and occasional judicial oversight, make implementation painfully slow.

For patients in terminal stages or their families, these delays amount to cruelty. The law, though sound in principle, is often hollow in practice. Reports from tertiary hospitals suggest that in most cases, families are forced to make decisions informally and outside the legal framework, thus placing doctors in a difficult legal position. The absence of an efficient implementation system erodes the very dignity the law was intended to preserve.

The U.K. model, while progressive, rests on strong institutional supports such as the National Health Service, universal access to general practitioners,



K. Kannan
former judge, Punjab and Haryana High Court, and author, Medicine and Law (2025)

India's constitutional promise of dignity in life must extend to dignity in dying

and a reliable regulatory framework. India's healthcare system is fragmented, uneven, and under-resourced. Moreover, its societal context – marked by deep family involvement, religious sensitivities, and varying literacy levels – makes end-of-life choices more complex. Introducing active euthanasia, even with safeguards, may inadvertently pressurise the elderly, disabled, or financially dependent to opt for death. As medical care is expensive and palliative care underdeveloped, this could produce ethical dilemmas of coercion.

There are also jurisprudential concerns. While Article 21 of the Constitution guarantees the right to life and has been interpreted to include the right to die with dignity, this cannot be stretched to mean a right to be killed. The Supreme Court has been cautious in maintaining the distinction between omission and commission, between allowing death and causing death. The Indian approach reflects a careful ethical conservatism suited to the realities of the country.

Charting its own course

Rather than expanding into active euthanasia, India should focus on refining its passive euthanasia protocol. A humane, efficient system can be built by leveraging digital tools and streamlining procedures. There is already growing consensus among medical professionals and legal scholars that the present system is too cumbersome.

Advance directives should be registered on a national digital portal, linked with Aadhaar for biometric verification. This system should allow patients to create, update, or revoke their directives easily. A treating physician should validate the patient's mental capacity and intent online.

Hospital ethics committees, consisting of senior doctors, a palliative care specialist, and a neutral third party, should be empowered to authorise withdrawal of life support within

48 hours. Exceptional cases can be flagged for further scrutiny.

Although a State-level ombudsman was initially proposed for oversight, India's experience with ombudsman schemes in banking and insurance has been mixed. Delays, limited enforcement powers, and public unfamiliarity have marred their effectiveness. Instead, a more transparent, decentralised review mechanism – perhaps built into hospital networks and monitored through digital dashboards – may be more suitable. Independent medical auditors or health commissioners with statutory backing could be alternatives worth exploring.

Mandatory safeguards, such as a seven-day cooling-off period, psychological counselling, and palliative care review, should remain part of the process to prevent misuse and ensure decisions are fully informed. These align with international best practices and help address fears of abuse, especially among vulnerable populations.

The way forward

India's constitutional promise of dignity in life must extend to dignity in dying. Reforming passive euthanasia does not require India to imitate the U.K.'s active euthanasia model, but it does compel it to make the current framework workable. Digitally driven procedures, local hospital-based ethics review, and effective (but not burdensome) oversight can make end-of-life decisions more accessible and humane. This path is consistent with Indian values, safeguards against abuse, and empowers patients without risking exploitation. In addition, medical education must integrate training on end-of-life care, including ethical and legal components. Public awareness campaigns are essential to normalise discussions on advance care planning. Without public trust and awareness, even the best laws will fail to serve their purpose.

We need an urban climate emergency fund

Disaster recovery cannot depend on ad hoc grants or delayed relief measures

STATE OF PLAY

Serish Naniseti
serish.n@thehindu.co.in



Buts of localised flooding across Hyderabad during the 2025 monsoon marooned residents, damaged roads, forced businesses to close, and disrupted electric supply for days. This year's deluge is yet another reminder of how rainfall patterns have shifted in Telangana. The average monsoon rainfall for Hyderabad through the 20th century was 76.88 cm, but over the last 25 years, the city has recorded an average of 91.84 cm. While scientists debate the extent to which this shift is attributable to climate change, for citizens, the cause is less pressing than the consequence.

In Hyderabad, the base-ments of high-rise apartments were flooded and cars were swept away. And as always, the poor, particularly those who live along the Musi River and lake beds, were impacted the most. They lost rations, home appliances, documents, and vehicles. For families in areas such as Moosa Nagar, Chaderghat, and Kishanbagh, which are on the edge of the river, flooding means a lost school year for children, rising cases of water-borne diseases, and the struggle to rebuild their lives with no insurance safety net.

Hyderabad's vulnerability is the result of willful ignorance of the city's natural gradient and watersheds, decades of civic corruption, and the systematic dereliction of zoning regulations. By shrinking lakes and encroaching on storm water drains, the city has systematically dismantled its natural floodwater flow patterns. Shifting rainfall patterns

are aggravating the problem. The State government's creation of the Hyderabad Disaster Management and Asset Protection Agency in 2024 was a step forward in dealing with the crisis. The agency has been working to clear lake bed encroachments and rejuvenate water bodies. It restored the Bathukamma Kunta lake, which offers a glimmer of hope. Yet, these interventions cannot undo the damage caused over decades. For instance, the main office of the Hyderabad Metropolitan Development Authority was built in the 1970s on what used to be one of the four lakes in the Ameerpet area.

Climate change is making cities vulnerable. Is India trying to make cities resilient? On July 24, 2025, MP Rookumari Choudhary asked in the Lok Sabha, "Will the Minister of Housing and Urban Affairs (MoHUA) be pleased to state the manner in which the government is incorporating climate resilience into urban planning and infrastructure development to address recurring issues such as flooding, waterlogging and damage to critical systems..."?

In response, the Minister of State for MoHUA, Tokhan Sahu, said that urban affairs falls under the purview of the State governments and urban local bodies. The only financial commitment that the Centre made in this year's budget was the Urban Challenge Fund of

₹1 lakh crore, aimed at implementing proposals for 'Cities as Growth Hubs', 'Creative Re-development of Cities', and 'Water and Sanitation'. "This fund finances up to 25% of the cost of bankable projects with a stipulation that at least 50% of the cost is funded from bonds, bank loans, and Public Private Partnership," he said.

What Hyderabad and other urban areas need is a dedicated climate emergency fund. Cities should be able to draw from such a fund for both short-term reconstruction and long-term adaptation. Disaster recovery cannot depend on ad hoc grants or delayed relief measures. If extreme events are going to be the new normal, funding mechanisms need to reflect that reality.

Building resilience is a key challenge, and the Telangana government's Musi Riverfront Development Plan embodies this effort. The plan aligns with the MoHUA's document of 2021, 'River Centric Urban Planning Guidelines', which factored in climate change and suggested the creation of active and passive recreational areas and enforcement of eco-sensitive zoning regulations. The project costs an estimated ₹1 lakh crore-₹1.5 lakh crore. Yet, securing funding has proved to be difficult. Without substantial commitment from the Centre, projects such as this risk becoming cosmetic.

Indian cities are engines of economic growth: they are home to over a third of the country's population and provide most of the jobs in the informal sector. But without climate resilience, these engines will stall. The story of Hyderabad's flooded streets is not just about poor drainage – it is about a development model that requires urgent funds to tide over the climate emergency unfolding in front of us.

Crimes against children surge in Assam, Rajasthan, and Kerala

A rise in the number of cases does not always mean a rise in the number of crimes; it may also indicate better reporting

DATA POINT

Devyanshi Bihani

In 2023, cases of crimes against children recorded the sharpest rise in three States – Assam, Rajasthan and Kerala, according to the latest data from the National Crimes Records Bureau.

In Assam, recorded cases of crimes against children surged by nearly 100% – from an average of around 5,100 cases between 2018 and 2022 to more than 10,000 in 2023. In Kerala, the number increased by 106% – from an average of more than 2,800 cases between 2018 and 2022 to more than 5,900 cases in 2023. In Rajasthan, the number increased by 70% – from an average of 6,200 cases between 2018 and 2022 to more than 10,500 cases in 2023.

In comparison, overall recorded cases of crimes against children in India increased by 25% in that period. **Map 1** shows the percentage change in cases of crimes against children in 2023 compared with the average number of cases recorded between 2018 and 2022. While these three States stand out, the reasons for the rise in each of them vary considerably.

In Assam, a record crackdown on child marriage led to a sharp rise in the number of cases filed under the Prohibition of Child Marriage Act, 2006. In fact, a close look at Assam's crime data against children shows that the spike was driven almost entirely by this State-led intervention. Between 2020 and 2022, about 150 cases were recorded annually in Assam under the Prohibition of Child Marriage Act; this increased to 5,267 in 2023. That year, cases related to child marriage accounted for nearly 52% of all crimes against children in the State, a dramatic jump from 3-4% in the preceding years, as shown in **Chart 2**.

In Rajasthan, two key factors appear to have driven the rise. The first is the sudden shift in the way

offences against children were categorised – from only non-POCSO sections to specific POCSO provisions. POCSO refers to the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences Act, 2012. In 2021 and 2022, over 2,700 cases were filed separately under the rape provision (Section 376 of the Indian Penal Code). However, in 2022 and 2023, no cases were filed independently under this section; instead, there was a corresponding rise in cases registered under the relevant POCSO provision. Cases filed under Sections 4 and 6 of the POCSO Act read with Section 376 of the IPC increased from just three in 2021 and 2022 to more than 3,500 in 2022 and 2023 (**Chart 3**). This shift – from filing cases solely under IPC provisions to invoking relevant sections of the POCSO Act – was seen across the country, but was most pronounced in Rajasthan.

It should be noted that the more accurate classification of child rape cases occurred alongside an actual increase in such offences in Rajasthan – from about 2,700 to 3,500 cases. However, whether this rise is primarily due to proper classification or an actual increase in offences is an open question.

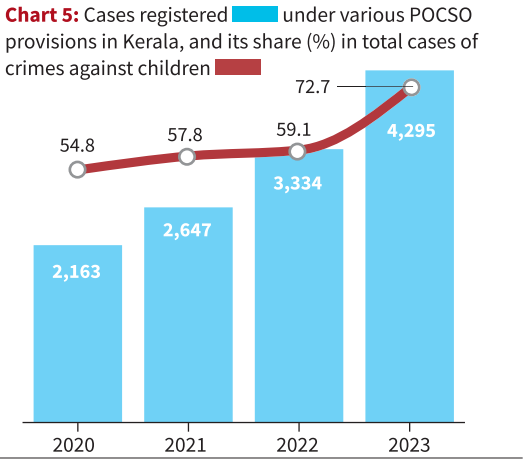
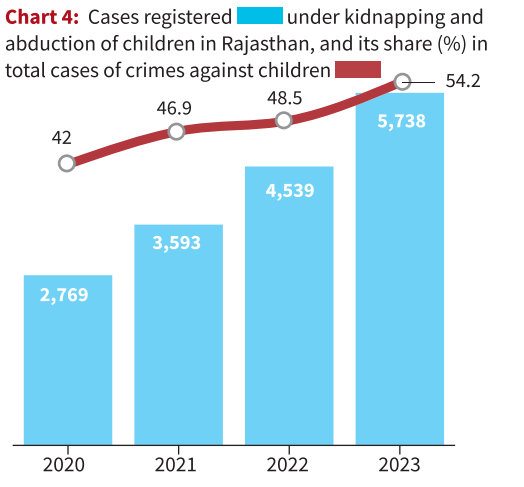
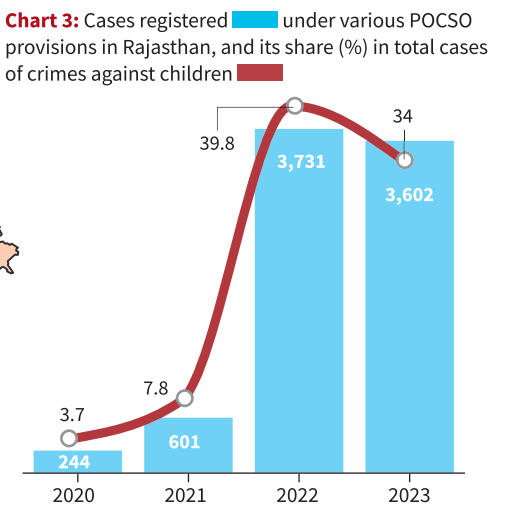
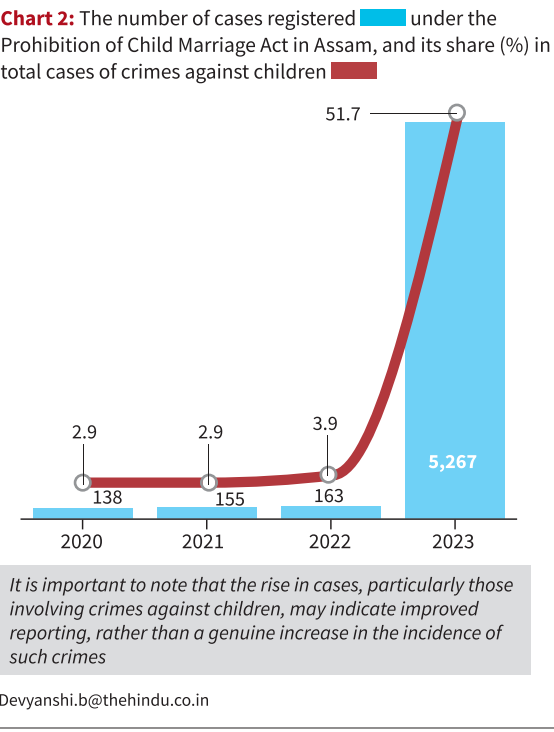
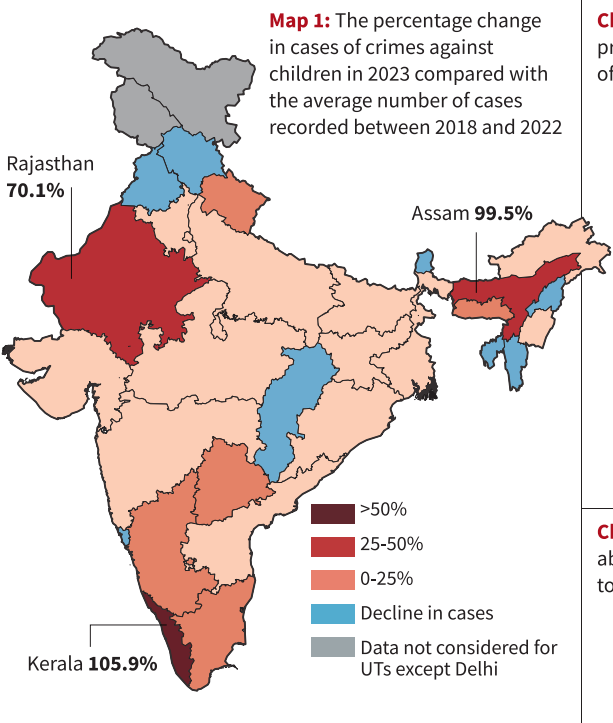
The second is that there was a sharp spike in cases related to the kidnapping and abduction of children. In Rajasthan, cases filed under various sections related to the kidnapping and abduction of children rose sharply, with their share in total crimes against children climbing to over 54% in 2023 – a steep increase (**Chart 4**).

There was a surge in POCSO cases in Kerala too. The increase appears partly linked to more accurate classification of offences under specific POCSO sections, accompanied by an increase in the reported cases (**Chart 5**).

It is important to note that the rise in cases, particularly those involving crimes against children, may indicate improved reporting, rather than a genuine increase in the incidence of such crimes.

Three States, one trend

The data for the charts were sourced from the National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB) from 2020 to 2023



FROM THE ARCHIVES

The **Hindu.**

FIFTY YEARS AGO OCTOBER 7, 1975

Computer to aid quick recruitment by UPSC

New Delhi, Oct. 6: The Union Public Service Commission is applying its mind now on how best it can improve the efficiency of its recruitment processes. It is also considering measures to ensure speedy completion of recruitment to various posts.

After a great deal of study, it has finally been decided to go in for computerising to achieve these two objectives. A contract for consultancy on the steps to be taken for computerisation has been concluded with the Indian Statistical Institute in Calcutta.

To ensure a more meaningful scrutiny of applications received for scientific and technical posts and for dealing with related matters, the UPSC has appointed in its Secretariat highly qualified technical personnel.

Simultaneously, the UPSC has initiated steps to constitute a data bank on experts in various fields who can be considered for appointments to senior positions and who can be utilised for assisting the Commission either as advisers while interviewing candidates or as examiners. The work has been completed in a number of fields while in a few fields it is yet to be completed.

It has been the experience of the UPSC that for some important posts, the right type of persons do not apply either because they do not want to face open competition or because they are not inclined to apply for the jobs. So the UPSC itself circulates periodically details of vacancies to important institutions which have the talent suitable for the posts. The data bank will enable the UPSC to keep the names of such persons ready and offer them the posts. From experience, the UPSC has found that this is a useful way of getting the most competent person for certain specialities.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO OCTOBER 7, 1925

Anti-malaria Congress

Rome, Oct. 6: The Anti-Malaria Congress closed, after unanimously approving acceptance of invitation from France to hold the next conference at Algiers in 1930 on the occasion of the centenary of the French occupation of Algiers and the fiftieth anniversary of the discovery of the parasite of Malaria in Algeria.

Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Migrants who died on the Serbia-Croatia border since 2014

413 A Chinese migrant has died and nine others have been rescued after their boat capsized crossing the Danube river on the Serbia and Croatia border. Croatia, a member of the European Union, is a major transit country for undocumented migrants trying to reach the political bloc. AFP

Jobs shed by the UNHCR this year amid a funding crisis

5,000 The United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees (UNHCR) is facing a towering crisis: amid surging global displacement, humanitarian funding has been fast evaporating since U.S. President Trump returned to office in January. AFP

Persons killed in the landslides and floods in north Bengal

28 The toll in the devastating landslides and floods in northern West Bengal rose to 28, as disaster management personnel continued rescue operations on Monday with several people still missing and thousands of tourists stranded in cut-off hill pockets, officials said. PTI

First-time voters in the upcoming Bihar Assembly election

14 In lakh. Over 7.4 crore people are eligible to vote in the upcoming Bihar Assembly elections, Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar announced on Monday. The CEC asserted that the Bihar elections will be conducted in a transparent and peaceful manner. PTI

Number of Gaza flotilla activists deported by Israel

171 Israel said it deported 171 more activists who were detained while taking part in an aid flotilla bound for Gaza. It added that the deportees were citizens of several countries, including Greece, Italy, France and the U.S. AFP
COMPILED BY THE HINDU DATA TEAM

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Can a third party be liable for marital disruption?

What is the alienation of affection tort? Do States in the U.S. enforce this common law? Does the Delhi High Court’s move go against the Supreme Court’s judgment in the Joseph Shine case? Can a family court decide damages against a third-party?

EXPLAINER

Shubham Shukla
Kartikey Singh

The story so far:
Recently, the Delhi High Court (HC), in a first-of-its-kind move in *Shelly Mahajan versus MS Bhanushree Bahl & Anr*, has opened the door for spouses to seek damages, in the civil sphere, from third parties who interfered in their marriage with malafide intention, causing its breakdown. Overruling the objections to the suit’s maintainability, the High Court issued summons in a wife’s suit seeking damages for Alienation of Affection (AoA), against her husband’s alleged affair partner. The decision revived an old Anglo-American concept, long abolished globally, putting the spotlight on a rarely tested legal idea in India. Seen as sidestepping the Supreme Court’s mandate in *Joseph Shine versus Union of India*, it also raises fresh questions on whether Indian civil courts can impose liability for third-party interference in marriage.

What is alienation of affection?
AoA is a term from common law referring to a “heart-balm” tort, which allows a spouse to sue a third party, usually the lover, for wilfully interfering in the marriage and causing ‘loss of affection and companionship’. The doctrine rests on the idea that marriage carries legal interests like consortium, intimacy, support and a shared life. Notably, the Indian legal framework neither codifies nor prohibits AoA, yet in *Pinakin Mahipatray Rawal versus State of Gujarat* (2013), the Supreme Court held that “alienation of affection by a stranger, if proved, is an intentional tort.” In *Indra Sarma versus V.K.V. Sarma*, the top court further noted that AoA could even give children a cause of action against a third party for alienating their father. However, the doctrine has never been used to award damages in India.

How do U.S. courts view AoA?
In the U.S., AoA lawsuits remain in only a few States, like Hawaii, Mississippi, New Mexico, North Carolina, South Dakota, and Utah, while most others have abolished them over the past century as outdated or prone to abuse. In these States, for establishing a claim, the aggrieved spouse must prove three elements – (1) existence of genuine love and affection in the marriage; (2) its loss; and (3) that a third party’s malicious conduct caused the loss. In contrast, States that have abolished AoA, through legislation or court rulings, consider such claims to be against public policy or incompatible with modern views of marriage. Thus, U.S. courts’ stance on AoA varies, as a small number of courts still uphold the tort with strict proof requirements, while the majority reject it, treating marital breakdowns as private matters not suitable for compensation under tort.

What did Supreme Court decide in Joseph Shine’s case?
In *Joseph Shine versus Union of India* (2018), a five-judge Constitution Bench led by then Chief Justice of India (CJI) Dipak Misra decriminalised adultery, striking it from the Indian Penal Code while clarifying it remains a civil wrong and valid ground for divorce. In 2020, another five-judge Bench headed by former CJI Sharad A. Bobde dismissed review petitions as meritless. Earlier, the law



GETTY IMAGES

punished a man with up to five years’ imprisonment for sexual relations with another man’s wife, but exempted the consenting wife from prosecution and did not apply it if the married man engaged in sexual relations with an unmarried woman or widow.
The 2018 *Joseph Shine* verdict held that consensual extramarital sexual relationships are no longer criminal, that is, no one can be jailed or fined for adultery. Striking down the colonial provision, the Supreme Court highlighted that adultery is not a crime if the husband connives or consents to his wife’s extramarital affair, thereby treating a married woman as her husband’s ‘chattel’. Emphasising that adultery is “absolutely a matter of privacy at its pinnacle,” the top court reasoned it should remain only a ground for divorce, not a crime. Thus, while decriminalised, adultery still carries civil consequences in family law or tort, as *Joseph Shine* did not expressly or impliedly foreclose such implications.
What did the Delhi High Court say?
In *Shelly Mahajan*, the Delhi High Court issued summons by taking a *prima facie* view that a spouse can sue the partner’s paramour for interfering in the marriage and seek compensation. The HC clarified that while Joseph Shine decriminalised adultery, it did not grant a licence for ‘extramarital relationships’ free of civil or

legal implications. Matrimonial statutes like the Hindu Marriage Act, 1955, offer remedies between spouses (for example, divorce), but none against a third party intruding into the marriage, the court further stressed.
Since matrimonial laws like the Hindu Marriage Act, 1955, provide remedies only between spouses, a civil tort claim against a third party for such interference remains open, in the absence of a specific bar, the court further stressed. However, the HC also acknowledged an important limitation that there has to be wrongful inducement or misconduct by the third party that caused the marital breakdown. When one spouse claims to have suffered legal injury on account of the disruption of the marital relationship, the law, under tort, recognises that compensation may be sought from those alleged to have contributed to the breach, the court noted.
The ruling clarified that while adultery is decriminalised and not punishable by the state, it still carries civil consequences in India. These include loss of consortium claims, compensation suits like the AoA case, and the personal remedy of divorce, where a betrayed spouse may petition the family court to dissolve the marriage on grounds of adultery. More importantly, the HC also laid down a three-fold test to decide such a claim. First, intentional and wrongful conduct by the paramour directed at alienating the marital

relationship of the aggrieved spouse. Second, clear causation linking that conduct to a legally cognisable injury to the aggrieved spouse. Third, the loss claimed is susceptible to rational assessment.
Who has jurisdiction to decide the AoA claim?
One key issue before the Delhi HC was whether AoA suits should go for trial in family courts or civil courts. It held that family courts have exclusive jurisdiction over matrimonial causes between spouses (divorce, alimony, custody, etc.), but a claim against a third party for interfering in a marriage is an independent civil injury (a tort), not arising from the marital relationship itself. Therefore, a family court cannot adjudicate a tort claim against a third person, and the civil court retains the jurisdiction. The Court added that if a spouse has a protectable interest in the marriage, third parties bear a correlative duty not to intentionally and wrongfully alienate that affection.
The Delhi High Court’s ruling marks a significant step in recognising civil recourse for spouses affected by interference in marriage. It opens the door for carefully framed claims that respect both personal autonomy and marital rights, offering a path for justice where harm has been caused.
Shubham Shukla and Kartikey Singh are lawyers based in New Delhi.

THE GIST

▼
Alienation of Affection is a term from common law referring to a “heart-balm” tort, which allows a spouse to sue a third party, usually the lover, for wilfully interfering in the marriage and causing ‘loss of affection and companionship’.
▼
In *Shelly Mahajan*, the Delhi High Court issued summons by taking a *prima facie* view that a spouse can sue the partner’s paramour for interfering in the marriage and seek compensation.
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Nitish gives ₹2,100 crore to women, opens Metro

The Hindu Bureau
PATNA

Hours before the Bihar election was announced, Chief Minister Nitish Kumar on Monday transferred ₹2,100 crore into the bank accounts of 21 lakh women beneficiaries under the Mukhyamantri Mahila Rojgar Yojana and inaugurated a section of Bihar’s first Metro rail service in Patna.

With this, the National Democratic Alliance (NDA) government in Bihar disbursed ₹12,100 crore to 1.21 crore women beneficiaries, with each woman receiving ₹10,000 under the scheme. While launching the scheme on September 26, Prime Minister Narendra Modi had transferred ₹7,500 crore to 75 lakh women beneficiaries via videoconferencing from New Delhi in the presence of Mr. Kumar. On October 3, Mr. Kumar transferred ₹2,500 crore to 25 lakh women beneficiaries.

Mr. Kumar also inaugurated the first phase of the elevated priority corridor of the Patna Metro rail project. For now, the service will cater to three stations – Patliputra Bus Terminal, Zero Mile, and Bhoothnath.

Election dates out, but coalitions yet to lock in seat-sharing

JD(U) wants largest share in NDA, with BJP providing for smaller allies; RJD offers 12 seats to Vikasheel Insaan Party, six to CPI, four to CPI(M)

Sobhana K. Nair
NEW DELHI

Though the Bihar Assembly election dates are out, the National Democratic Alliance (NDA) and the Opposition grand alliance are yet to finalise seat-sharing. Each side is struggling to strike a balance between aspirations of its partners and winnability.

The composition of each bloc has changed since the 2020 election, with additional claimants for the 243 seats. As per sources, in the NDA, the Janata Dal(U) could contest 107 seats and the BJP 105. The remaining 31 will be divided among the Lok Janshakti Party (Ram Vilas), Hindustani Awam Morcha, and Rashtriya Lok Samta Party.

“JD(U) is the pre-eminent partner in the alliance and should be given the largest share. As far as LJP (RV), HAM and RLSP are concerned, they have been BJP’s allies and it is for the BJP to negotiate the deal

Party performance

The table shows the party and alliance-wise vote share and number of seats won in the 2020 Bihar Assembly elections

Alliance	Parties	Vote share (%)	Seats won
NDA	BJP, JD(U), VIP, HAM(S)	37.3	125
Grand alliance	RJD, Congress, Left parties	37.2	110
Grand Democratic Secular Front	AIMIM, BSP, RLSP	4.5	6
Others	-	21	2

SOURCE: ELECTION COMMISSION OF INDIA

with them,” JD(U) spokesperson K.C. Tyagi said.

In 2020, the JD(U) contested 115 seats, BJP 110, and HAM seven. The united Lok Janshakti Party contested 134 seats. Chirag Paswan’s decision to contest alone led to a split in the party. Mr. Paswan’s LJP (RV) is now in the NDA. “We do not want to be saddled with seats that no one else is willing to contest,” a top LJP leader said.

It isn’t easy for the grand alliance either. The RJD began discussions on Sunday with its allies.

Sources say it has offered 12 seats to the Vikasheel Insaan Party. The CPI has been offered six seats and CPI(M) four. The CPI is learnt to be unhappy. To negotiate, party general secretary D. Raja will reach Patna on Tuesday.

No formal offer has been made to the CPI(ML), which has demanded 40 seats, or the Congress. The RJD, which contested 144 seats in 2020, do not want to climb down below 130, leaving 113 seats to be divided between five allies, including the Congress.

Ticket seekers lose no time, dash off to party offices to press their case

Amarnath Tewary
PATNA

Soon after the Election Commission announced the Bihar Assembly election dates on Monday, ticket seekers and their supporters descended on the offices of major parties here to press their case.

With a crowd building up outside the Janata Dal (U) office, vehicular traffic on Beorchand Patel Path slowed down. The district administration has erected two makeshift shelters at the main entrance of the party office for men and women constables. Similar scenes were seen outside the offices of the BJP and the principal Opposition party, Rashtriya Janata Dal, a few metres ahead on the same stretch of the road.

“Within hours of the election dates being announced, our leader has come to the party office to stake his claim,” said a person in white kurta-pyjamas inside an SUV parked outside the JD(U) office. Displayed on the vehicle was the slogan “Hum hain Aurai Vidhan Sabha ka bharishya (We are the future of the Aurai Assembly constituency)”.

Aurai is in Muzaffarpur district of north Bihar. In the 2020 Assembly elec-



Anxious wait: BJP leaders watching the live telecast of the Election Commission’s press conference on the Bihar Assembly election schedule at the party office in Patna on Monday. PTI

tion, the BJP won the seat. The party’s Ram Surat Rai defeated the Communist Party of India (Marxist-Leninist) candidate Mohammad Aftab Alam by over 47,000 votes.

Poll prospects

Outside the BJP office, there was a traffic jam. Big billboards and posters of party leaders were visible from afar. People could be seen going in and coming out. At a tea stall outside, a few people in spotless white clothes sipped tea while discussing the poll prospects of the party this time. “Take it from me.

The election is not going to happen in more than three phases and our party is going to form the government in the State,” Sahyog Sharma, a businessman from Lakhisarai, said hours before the dates were announced.

Senior BJP leader and Deputy Chief Minister Vijay Kumar Sinha hails from Lakhisarai. Mr. Sinha has been a four-time MLA from the Lakhisarai constituency since 2005. Asked if he was a supporter of the BJP leader, the businessman quipped: “No, I’m a worker of the party.” Some distance away at

the RJD’s party office, a few vehicles were parked outside the premises while the boundary wall was plastered with posters of party leaders Tejashwi Yadav and Lalu Prasad.

“Tejashwi Yadav is going to be the Chief Minister of the State this time, if vote chori [theft] will not happen,” said a young party member wearing a green gamcha (towel) around his neck.

“The Mahagatbandhan (grand alliance) had secured 110 seats [in 2020], just 12 short of a majority in the 243-member State Assembly,” he said.

Both NDA, grand alliance claim they will form new government in Bihar

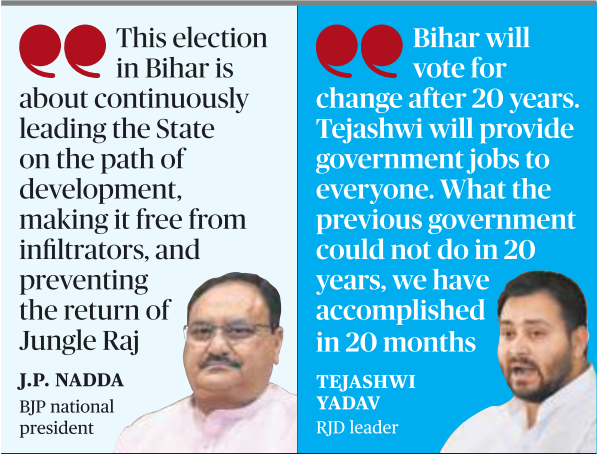
Amit Bhelari
PATNA

Both the ruling and Opposition parties in Bihar on Monday claimed they would form the next government in the State, following the Election Commission’s announcement of Assembly election dates.

Senior Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) leader and Deputy Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary welcomed the commission’s decision to hold the election in two phases. Speaking to presspersons in Patna, he said the public would bless the National Democratic Alliance (NDA) with a landslide victory.

Mr. Choudhary said that the NDA’s development efforts had left the Opposition without issues to raise, and that the NDA government’s return to power on November 14 was certain.

BJP president J.P. Nadda also welcomed the announcement by posting a message on X, saying that under the leadership of the Prime Minister, the NDA government in Bihar had become synonymous with public welfare and good governance.



“This election in Bihar is about continuously leading the State on the path of development, making it free from infiltrators, and preventing the return of Jungle Raj. I have full confidence that the people of Bihar will bless and support the NDA,” Mr. Nadda said.

“NDA workers ready” Janata Dal (United) State president Umesh Singh Kushwaha said that workers of all alliance partners in the NDA were ready to enter the electoral battle.

“Under the leadership of Nitish Kumar, the NDA is fully prepared to script a

new victory on November 14. Over the past 20 years, Nitishji has transformed Bihar, brought the rays of development to all sections of society, and ensured a fear-free environment by establishing the rule of law,” Mr. Kushwaha said.

Union Minister and Lok Janshakti Party (Ram Vilas) national president Chirag Paswan also posted a message on X, saying now is the time to take Bihar to new heights on the national map.

“The LJP(RV) is fully prepared to enter the electoral battlefield with the goal of its “Bihar First-Bihari First” vision. Let us

come together in this festival of democracy and ensure our participation in building a new Bihar,” Mr. Paswan said.

Letter to people

Opposition Rashtriya Janata Dal (RJD) leader and former Deputy Chief Minister Tejashwi Yadav penned a letter to the people of Bihar and went live on Facebook.

“Bihar will vote for change after 20 years. Tejashwi will provide government jobs to everyone. What the previous government could not do in 20 years, we have accomplished in 20 months. Every voter is eager for change, and everyone wants the government of Mahagatbandhan,” Mr. Yadav said.

Attacking Mr. Kumar, the RJD leader said Bihar needs a Chief Minister in good health.

Meanwhile, while addressing a press conference in Patna, Jan Suraj Party founder Prashant Kishor said, “This time, the people of Bihar will vote not for Modi, Nitish, or Lalu, but for the bright future of their children.”

LAB questions claims of ‘normalcy’ in Ladakh

The Hindu Bureau
LEH

The Leh Apex Body (LAB), which has spearheaded the agitation for Statehood and Sixth Schedule status for Ladakh, on Monday questioned the administration’s claims of normalcy, and demanded “lifting of all restrictions” and an “end to harassment of lumberdars (village headmen)” who supported the LAB’s demands.

The demand came amid improved situation in Leh, with the administration announcing fresh relaxations. It included reopening of schools up to Class 12, resumption of public transport, and opening of shops from 7 a.m. till 6 p.m. in Leh town.

Four civilians were killed and around 90 were injured during protests demanding Statehood on September 24, fuelling tension in the region, and were followed by spells of curfew. Restrictions continue on the assembly of more than four people, under Section 163 of BNSS. Mobile Internet services also remain suspended.

Jaishankar says India’s interests are best secured by strategic autonomy

Suhasini Haidar
NEW DELHI

India has always exerted its strategic autonomy, External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar said on Monday, referring to the country’s decision to sign a friendship pact with the Soviet Union in 1971 as a “necessary” choice, given the triangular threats India faced from the other big powers, the United States and China.

Speaking at the launch of the Aravalli Summit, organised by the Jawaharlal Nehru University’s School of International Studies, marking its 70th anniversary, Mr. Jaishankar, an alumnus of the school himself, said that it was necessary for students of foreign policy to factor in a future of multi-alignment and multipolarity. Mr. Jaishankar said recent global volatility, including the imposition of tariffs by the U.S., had made the case for multi-alignment, more than allying with any one power, much stronger.

“Imagine if [India were] not today adopting strategic autonomy. Please tell me, which country in the world would you like to join up with and put [India’s] future in their hands,” he asked. “I can’t think of anybody. [India’s] interest is best secured by maximising its options, maintaining [its] freedom of choices,” he said.

Mr. Jaishankar’s comments came a day after he said that trade negotiations with the U.S. would have to respect India’s “red-lines”.

National interest

The government has also been facing increased pressure from the U.S. over the issue of Russian oil imports. While Mr. Jaishankar did not refer directly to India’s position, amidst reports that Russian oil imports in September have been considerably reduced, he praised India’s stand during the 1971 war



S. Jaishankar at the launch of the Aravalli Summit at Jawaharlal Nehru University in New Delhi on Monday. X/@DRSJAISHANKAR

The purpose of India’s policy is not to solve problems, but to ‘manage relationships to national advantage’, says Jaishankar

with Pakistan and Liberation of Bangladesh, when India signed a Friendship Treaty with Soviet Union.

“What we did was in our national interest – we were dealing with a U.S.-China triangle and we had to find a way out of this,” Mr. Jaishankar said, answering questions from students at the event, which was co-hosted by the Ministry of External Affairs, and the newly launched Delhi-based Adani Group-owned think tank Chintan Research Foundation. “So, the decision we took in the midst of an acute national security crisis, was necessary,” he added, addressing the audience, which included a number of diplomats, including the Ambassador of Russia to India Denis Alipov, and Bangladesh High Commissioner Riaz Hamidullah.

Asked about India’s neighbourhood first policy amid signs of strains with a number of neighbours including Bangladesh, and protest-led regime changes in Sri Lanka and Nepal, Mr. Jaishankar said India has to

be prepared to unilaterally “underwrite the infrastructure for cooperation” with countries in the region, and should become the “go-to option” for neighbouring countries when in need.

Managing relations

“Every country has problematic neighbours, and every big country has more problematic neighbours,” the External Affairs Minister said, stressing that the purpose of India’s policy was not merely to solve problems, but to “manage relationships to national advantage”. Without directly naming Pakistan, he said that barring one country, India has effected “transformational change” in projects with neighbouring countries, in the areas of energy, roads, railway lines, and the movement of people.

Asked about the “re-hyphenation” of India with Pakistan, post Operation Sindoor, and a reference to recent developments where the U.S., Saudi Arabia, China, Türkiye, and other countries have forged closer ties with Islamabad, Mr. Jaishankar said India “cannot wish away a difficult neighbour”, as that is a “reality”. But he said that other countries no longer draw an equivalence between India and Pakistan.

Police should be thanked for their handling of stampede: Kamal

The Hindu Bureau
KARUR

Makkal Needhi Maiam leader and actor Kamal Haasan on Monday said the police should be thanked, and not blamed, for their handling of the September 27 stampede that claimed 41 lives at actor and TVK founder Vijay’s rally in Karur.

He visited the site of the stampede at Velusampyuram and met the bereaved families. He urged the public and the media to show restraint and compassion.

Appreciating the government’s decision not to permit the rally at the Lighthouse Corner, as sought initially by the TVK, Mr. Haasan said, “This is not



MNM president Kamal Haasan visiting the site of the stampede at Velusampyuram in Karur on Monday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

the time to appreciate anyone; but we have to thank them for denying permission for the rally at the bridge [Lighthouse Corner]. That would have been a larger black mark... My only consolation is that it has not become a bigger tragedy. Had permission

been given for that spot and people fallen into the river [Amaravati], what would have been their state,” he asked.

Pointing to former Minister V. Senthilbalaji, who accompanied him, Mr. Haasan said, “Instead of asking how they came so

quickly that day, the solace is that they did come. Had they not arrived at the right time, we would have lost more lives. We must thank them.”

Commending Chief Minister M.K. Stalin’s handling of the situation, he said, “The Chief Minister has shown exemplary leadership in a dignified manner. We are proud of it, and we should thank him for it.”

When asked about AIADMK general secretary Edappadi K. Palaniswami’s remark that the government must take responsibility, he said, “Any government should take responsibility. But what has happened is *sub judice*; we should not comment

further.”

Answering a question about the alleged lapses in the security arrangements at the venue, he said, “We should also see who is making such allegations. Don’t take sides. If you have to take a side, take the people’s side.”

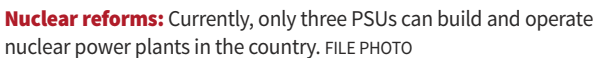
He also lauded the role of the media in uncovering the facts.

Hands over solatium

Later in the day, a press release from the MNM said Mr. Haasan handed over a compensation of ₹1 lakh each to the families of eight stampede victims. The release added that MNM would hand over the relief to the remaining 33 families on Tuesday.

In a unique initiative to promote sustainable tourism and enhance rural livelihoods, the Indian Army inaugurated a tent-based homestay facility on Monday in the scenic border village of Garbyang, Pithoragarh district, Uttarakhand. The inauguration ceremony was led by Lieutenant-General D.G. Misra, General Officer Commanding, North India area. "Under Operation Sadbhavana, we are striving for sustainable development in border villages. This project will not only promote tourism but also spur rural development," he said. The project aligns with the Centre's Vibrant Villages Programme, the Army said in a communique.

In February, however,



Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman said in her Budget speech that the government intended to amend two Acts – the Atomic Energy Act and the Civil Liability for Nuclear Damage Act – to enable private companies, including foreign companies, to form partnerships, and build and operate nuclear plants in India.

Despite the India-U.S. nuclear deal of 2008 formally allowing sale of nuclear technologies to India, though with built-in periodic checks and scrutiny by the International Atomic Energy Agency, clauses in India's Atomic Energy Act and the Civil Liability for Nuclear Damage Act

(2010) have been impediments since they impose practically unlimited liability on foreign suppliers of nuclear equipment in case of an accident.

Alignment of laws

The effort is to align India's laws on liability with that of conventions such as the Convention on Supplementary Compensation for Nuclear Damage (CSC)," the official noted. "However, we also have to bring clarity on questions such as who will be responsible, whether it is the private sector or the government, power plant operators, for safe disposal of nuclear waste as well as the reprocessing of spent nuclear

fuel. There is also discussion on enabling research and development of core nuclear technologies.”

The government's thrust to encourage greater private sector participation is with the larger objective of installing 100 GW of nuclear capacity by 2047. This is premised not only on importing foreign reactors but also developing Bharat Small Reactors (BSRs) and exploring partnerships with the private sector. BSRs are 220 MW Pressurized Heavy Water Reactors (PHWRs). These reactors are being upgraded to reduce land requirements, making them suitable for deployment near industries such as steel, aluminium, and metals units, serving as captive power plants to aid in decarbonisation efforts.

The plan involves private entities providing land, cooling water, and capital while the NPCIL handles design, quality assurance, and operation and maintenance. This initiative aligns with India's commitment to achieving 500 GW of non-fossil fuel-based energy generation and meeting 50% of requirements from renewable energy by 2030.

The government's first ever Emerging Science, Technology and Innovation Conclave (ESTIC), to be held in November, is meant to reflect the strides and "evolution" that India has made in science and technology over the years and is not a mere "upgrade" of the traditional Indian Science Congress, Science Minister Jitendra Singh said on Monday.

As *The Hindu* had reported in September, the Department of Science and Technology (DST) was set to organise the first-ever ESTIC in lieu of the Indian Science Congress.

A spat between the DST and ISC organisers – the Kolkata-based Indian Science Congress Association that is now in the courts further – ended up being the tombstone to the ISC, that was last held in its traditional format – with Prime Minister Narendra Modi in attendance – in Ludhiana in 2020.

“It would not be very polite to call the ESTIC as an upgraded ISC. But just as changes in technology over the years have seen the presentation formats, scientific themes and the manner of organisation evolve, similarly the ESTIC

too will reflect India's growing stature in science and technology and showcase achievements in technology, growth of start-ups and ambitions for the future," Mr. Jitendra Singh said at a press conference.

He said Mr. Modi would “likely” inaugurate ESTIC and every year the conclave would be held in different places outside Delhi. “We intend to give it a greater international flavour every year but that would require planning over 12 months. This year we commenced preparations a little late, but you will see it evolve, with greater international participation of Nobel Laureates and leading figures, in the coming years” the Minister added.

75 exhibition stalls

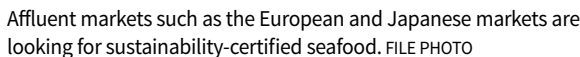
The inaugural ESTIC event will be held at the Bharat Mandapam here on November 3 and 4. All of the government scientific Ministries, ranging from atomic energy, space and information technology, will be involved in its organisation. According to the event website, it will have 11 thematic technical sessions, 75 exhibition stalls by 'deep tech' start-ups. Nobel Laureate Andre Geim (2010, Physics) is expected to make an appearance.

About 10 Indian marine and saline fish and shrimp varieties are set to get the global Marine Stewardship Council (MSC) certification soon. The first batch is set to be submitted for the certification in 2026.

According to experts, the certification is likely to increase the revenue of the fisheries sector by 30% and help fishermen and traders find new markets other than the U.S. in the event of further trade restrictions due to the higher tariffs.

The certification will also help fishing communities begin ecologically sustainable fishing practices and ensure steady incomes.

Fisheries Development Commissioner K. Mohammed Koya told *The*



Hindu that the Union Government, under the Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana (PMMSY), would subsidise the certification process, which is done by third-party auditors.

Mr. Koya said that global affluent markets, such as European and Japanese ones, are looking for sustainably sourced fish.

“Sustainability is part of our fisheries. Some of our

dressing the technical gaps, including stock assessments for shrimp, squid, cuttlefish and octopus, which are part of the varieties that await MSC certification.

It is primarily based on the Food and Agriculture Organisation's (FAO) Code of Conduct for Responsible Fishing and Guidelines for the Eco-labelling of Fish and Fishery Products from Marine Capture Fisheries.

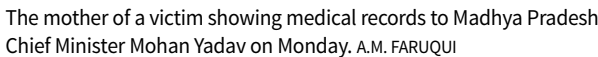
Advanced stages

Speaking recently at a technical session jointly hosted by the MSC and the Sustainable Seafood Network India (SSNI) and the Seafood Exporters Association of India (SEAI), MSC's India head Ranjit Suseelan said the prioritised fisheries are in the advanced stages of assessment, raising expectations of MSC certification in the next year.

The Madhya Pradesh government on Monday suspended the Deputy Controller and two drug inspectors of the Food and Drugs Administration (FDA) in connection with the death of 14 children, allegedly after consuming a cough syrup adulterated with a toxic chemical.

Deputy Controller Shobhit Kosta and drug inspectors Gaurav Sharma (Chhindwara) and Sharad Kumar Jain (Jabalpur) were suspended, while Controller Dinesh Maurya was transferred following directions from Chief Minister Mohan Yadav after he held a high-level meeting, a government statement said.

Speaking to reporters, Mr. Yadav said that instructions have also been issued to ban cough syrups made



by two other manufacturers "We will not tolerate any kind of negligence with respect to matters concerning human life," Mr. Yadav said.

The Chief Minister also visited various villages in Chhindwara district, and met with the families that lost their children.

State Congress president Jitu Patwari visited Chhindwara as well. He demanded the removal of De-

The Maharashtra Food and Drug Administration (FDA) urged the public on Monday to immediately stop the sale and use of a specific batch of the Coldrif syrup, following reports of child deaths in Madhya Pradesh and Rajasthan, allegedly linked to the medicine.

The appeal comes amid growing concerns over an adulterated batch of the syrup. The FDA had issued an advisory on Sunday, calling for the immediate suspension of sale, distribution, and use of the medicine.

Speaking to *The Hindu*, FDA Joint Commissioner (Drugs) D.R. Gahane said, "Our citizens are safe. We held a meeting with the Drug Control Authorities in Tamil Nadu... they confirmed that Coldrif cough syrups were not supplied in the State."

When a hunter transformed himself through inner awakening and became Valmiki, it heralded the arrival of a moral guide for mankind in the form of Valmiki's Ramayana, detailing the life of Rama in verse form, said Damal S. Ramakrishnan. After his transformation through meditation on Rama nama, Valmiki built an ashram on the very same spot and lived the life of a hermit. When Narada arrived there, Valmiki asked him to name one human being with 16 sterling qualities. Narada told him about Rama, precising everything from His birth to His Pattabhishekam.

His mind filled with Narada's discourse upon a man who had both compassion and renunciation, Valmiki went to the Tamasa river for a dip where a pair of curlews were singing when a hunter shot down the male bird, leaving the female in utter distress. Moved by the birds' plight, Valmiki cursed, "May you know no rest for endless years since you killed one of the pair of curlews." Wondering what impelled him to curse, Valmiki decided to turn the verse into a sloka. At the same time, Brahma appeared in the ashram and endorsing the sloka, and commanded him to tell the world the story of Rama, a man devoted to dharma and possessed of the highest qualities and accomplishments. Brahma further assured the sage that "Whatever happened in public or in private to Rama and Sita, or the rakshasas would all be known to him, even the events hitherto unknown to Valmiki. Brahma further affirmed that nothing contained in his poem shall be falsified. He left after saying, "As long as the hills abide, so long shall the story of Rama be reputed in all the worlds."

SC to decide on securities transaction tax’s constitutionality

Petition contends that the direct tax on securities transactions violates fundamental rights to equality and to trade or earn a livelihood

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court of India on Monday decided to examine a plea challenging the constitutional validity of the Securities Transaction Tax (STT), a direct tax levied on securities transactions through a listed stock exchange, as imposed under the Finance Act, 2004.

A Bench headed by Justice J.B. Pardiwala issued formal notice to the Union Government, through the Ministry of Finance, on the petition filed by Aseem Juneja, represented by advocate Siddhartha K. Garg, who contended that the STT violated fundamental rights to equality and to trade or earn a livelihood and the basic right to live with dignity.

The petition clarified that the challenge to the STT was not because the



The petition clarified it was not because the taxation was currently high. THE HINDU

taxation on the stock market participants had increased or that the taxation was currently high.

“The current petition is instead questioning the legality of the tax imposed in the form of STT... Firstly, it violates the principle of double taxation as the petitioner (a stock market trader) pays capital gains tax on the profit made in the market and then also has to pay STT, over and above this capital gains tax alrea-

dy paid on the same transaction,” the plea submitted.

Secondly, Mr. Juneja contended that STT was the only tax in India which was imposed on the “sheer act of carrying out a profession and has to be paid irrespective of whether there is a profit made or not, which makes it almost punitive or deterrent in nature.”

“Every tax in India is on the profit at the year-end but STT is applicable even if the stock market trader is operating in a loss. STT was introduced in 2004 to combat tax evasion in the stock market. This means that STT to stock market participants is what TDS is to salaried individuals. But the problem is that the TDS is refunded at the end of the year or adjusted with the income tax but no such provision is made for STT and the trader has to pay both,” Mr. Juneja noted.

SC issues notice on plea for portal on financial holdings

Aaratrika Bhaumik
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Monday issued notices to the Union Government and several financial regulators on a public interest litigation petition seeking the creation of an integrated digital platform that would allow citizens to access information about all their financial holdings, whether operational, inactive, or unclaimed, across entities regulated by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI), the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI), and the Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI).

A Bench of Justices Vikram Nath and Sandeep Mehta sought responses from the Union of India, the Ministry of Consumer Affairs, the RBI, SEBI, IRDAI, the National Savings Institute, the Employees’ Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO), and the Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority (PFRDA).

IIHL acquires 100% stake in Sterling Bank

The Hindu Bureau
MUMBAI

IndusInd International Holdings Ltd. (IIHL), Mauritius has announced the acquisition of 100% stake in Sterling Bank, Bahamas.

The company said in a statement that it had earlier acquired 51% stake in September 2022, and has now completed the acquisition of the remaining 49% equity. The acquisition was

made through IIHL’s wholly owned subsidiary, IIHL (Capital), Mauritius.

Sterling Bank will be renamed as ‘IIHL Bank & Trust Ltd.’

IIHL, a Mauritius-based entity with a net worth of

\$1.26 billion as of August 31, 2025, has a diversified investment portfolio across the Banking, Financial Services, Securities, and Insurance (BFSI) sectors. IIHL is the promoter of IndusInd Bank Ltd.

INBRIEF



ONGC to invest ₹8,110 cr. on 172 onshore wells in A.P.

Oil and Natural Gas Corporation Limited (ONGC) is set to invest ₹8,110 crore for onshore development and production of oil and gas from 172 wells in eight PML (petroleum mining lease) blocks in Andhra Pradesh. A committee under the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change has recommended Environmental Clearance for the project in a meeting held last month. While recommending the EC, the committee directed the ONGC to comply with all the environmental protection measures and safeguards proposed in the documents submitted to the Ministry. PTI

India’s services PMI eases to 60.9 in September

The growth of India’s services sector eased in September from the recent high in August, as new business and activity expanded at slower rates, according to a private monthly survey released on Monday. The seasonally adjusted HSBC India Services PMI Business Activity Index fell to 60.9 in September, from a 15-year high of 62.9 in August, amid competitive conditions and cost-control measures. Notwithstanding the moderation, the September Services PMI index was well above the neutral mark of 50 to signal another substantial upturn in output. PTI

Canara Robeco AMC set to raise ₹1,326 crore in IPO

Canara Robeco Asset Management Ltd. announced plans to raise ₹1,326 crore in initial public offering (IPO). The complete offer for sale of 49,854,357 equity shares by the promoter selling shareholders comprises 25,924,266 equity shares by Canara Bank and up to 23,930,091 equity Shares by ORIX Corporation Europe. The company has set a price band of ₹253 to ₹266 a share that is to be subscribed in lots of 56 equity shares and in multiples of 56, thereafter. Canara is selling a 13% stake in the IPO, while Robeco (ORIX Corporation) is selling 12%.

Sonowal accords ceremonial welcome to ‘Very Large Gas Carrier’ Shivalik

V. Kamalakara Rao
VISAKHAPATNAM

Union Minister of Ports, Shipping and Waterways Sarbananda Sonowal accorded a ceremonial welcome to the nation’s first Very Large Gas Carrier (VLGC) Shivalik at the Visakhapatnam port, on its maiden call to the nation on Monday.

Shivalik, recently inducted under the Indian flag by the Shipping Corporation of India (SCI) Ltd. on September 10, represents a significant leap in India’s maritime and energy logistics capability.

Mr. Sonowal congratulated the SCI team and lauded the Visakhapatnam Port Authority (VPA) for facilitating the vessel’s smooth handling during its inaugural LPG consignment operation, at the port’s LPG terminal.

Other projects

Mr. Sonowal also inaugurated several developmental projects at Visakhapatnam Port Authority at Sagarmala Conventions, Saligrampuram.

These included the Operation & Maintenance of East Quay (EQ)-1A Terminal, awarded to M/s Green Energy Resources with an investment of ₹130 crore.

The project includes deployment of two 120-tonne Harbour Mobile Cranes (HMCs) and connected infrastructure for a 5+1 year period, enhancing capacity by 3 MMTPA.

The initiative is expected to generate around 150 jobs, reduce logistics costs, and strengthen Visakhapatnam Port’s position as a key cargo hub on the East Coast.



Union Ports & Shipping Minister Sarbananda Sonowal flagging off VLGC Shivalik. V. RAJU

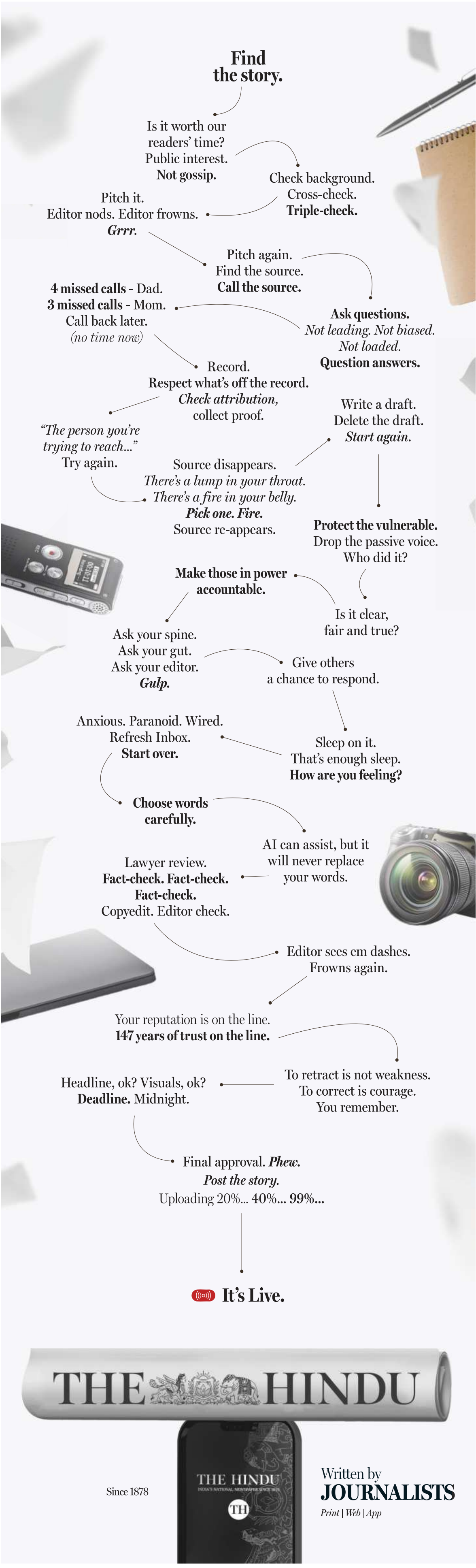
The Minister also inaugurated the Smart Video Surveillance Project, valued at ₹37.53 crore, executed by M/s RailTel Corporation of India Ltd., Hyderabad. The initiative integrates AI/ML-based Video Analytics, IoT technologies, and an Integrated Command Control Centre (ICCC) with five years of O&M support.

Designed to be implemented within 12 months, the project enhances port security, operational efficiency, and compliance while enabling real-time monitoring, asset tracking, and predictive analytics –making VPA a future-ready ‘smart port.’

Another major project inaugurated was the Digital Health Card System, implemented by M/s Triunfador Pvt. Ltd., Visakhapatnam, at a cost of ₹1 crore.

The project, to be completed in three months, enables digital access to health records for employees, pensioners, and dependents through QR/Aadhaar-linked smart health cards.

Visakhapatnam MP M. Sribharat accompanied Mr. Sonowal, among others.



Ukraine drone strikes cut off power for thousands in Russia



Jilly Cooper, British best-selling author of racy romance, dies at 88



Khaleda Zia's exiled son plans to return for Bangladesh elections



Iran says it will not resume nuclear talks with Europeans 'at this stage'



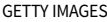
Chaos in France as PM Lecornu quits a month after Macron appointed him

Medicine Nobel for scientists who demystified the immune system

UN to probe human rights violations in Afghanistan

Hamas, Israel hold indirect talks on Gaza

Brits slams her fifth ton in 2025, most by a player in a calendar year



Brits-Luus' 159-run stand the highest for SA in World Cups



We want to play our A-game against England: Sultana

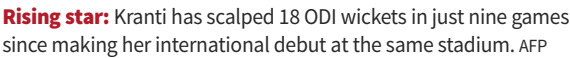


Dabang Delhi completes the double over Pink Panthers



Mlaba, Brits and Luus star as South Africa outplays New Zealand

Kranti — the new revolution in Indian women's cricket



Five months later, the 22-year-old now has 18 ODI wickets in just nine games, has earned the faith of the think-tank over other experienced players, and has also shown courage with the bat. All this against quality opponents like England

Upbeat Bangladesh faces a stern test against England

Time ripe for Rahul to reap the fruits of labour at home

Milan, Juventus fail to break the deadlock

CM
Y
K

INBRIEF



Former WI all-rounder Bernard Julien passes away

Former West Indies all-rounder Bernard Julien, who was part of the 1975 World Cup-winning squad, died at the age of 75 on Saturday in Valsayn in Trinidad and Tobago. The left-handed Julien played 24 Tests for the West Indies, scoring 866 runs at an average of 30.92 and took 50 wickets at 37.36. In 12 ODIs, he scored 86 runs and claimed 18 wickets at 25.72.

Velavan, Chotrani advance in Open Squash Classic

India's Velavan Senthilkumar and Veer Chotrani advanced to the round-of-16 in the Open Squash Classic, a \$74,000 PSA Bronze event in New York. Velavan defeated Pakistan's Md. Ashab Irfan 11-2, 11-8, 14-12 in the opening round on Sunday, while Chotrani beat Abhay Singh 6-11, 11-6, 11-5, 11-5. Ramit Tandon received a first-round bye.



Samson is official ambassador for Premier League in India

Indian cricketer Sanju Samson has been appointed as the official ambassador for the Premier League in India. He met former England striker Michael Owen during a Premier League fan engagement event in Mumbai.

Fabio Cannavaro appointed Uzbekistan coach

Uzbekistan has hired former Italy defender Fabio Cannavaro as national team coach ahead of its first World Cup appearance next year. Cannavaro is taking over the role with immediate effect, the Uzbekistan football association said on Monday.

LIVE TELECAST

Tennis: Shanghai Masters, Sony Sports Ten 1 & LIV, 10 a.m.
Women's ODI World Cup: Star Sports 1 & JioHotstar, 3 p.m.
PVL: Sony Sports Ten 1 (SD & HD) & LIV, 6.30 p.m.
PKL: Star Sports 2 (SD & HD) & JioHotstar, 8 p.m.

Indian squad for AFC u-17 Women's Asian Cup Qualifiers named

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

The Indian under-17 women's football team head coach Joakim Alexandersson on Monday named a 23-member squad for the 2026 AFC under-17 Asian Cup Qualifiers from October 13 to 17 in Bishkek. Placed in a three-team

Group G, India will face host Kyrgyz Republic on Oct. 13 and Uzbekistan on Oct. 17. The group winner will qualify for the 12-team final tournament in China next year.

The squad: Goalkeepers: Munni, Surajmuni Kumari, Thameena Fathima; **Defenders:** Alena Devi Sarangthem, Alisha

Lyngdoh, Binita Horo, Divyani Linda, Elizabeth Lakra, Joyshini Chanu Huidrom, Ritu Badaik, Taniya Devi Tonambam; **Midfielders:** Anushka Basnett, Anita Dungdung, Bonifilia Shullai, Julian Nongmaithem, Pritika Barman, Shveta Rani, Thandamoni Baskay. **Forwards:** Anushka Kumari, Anwita Raghuraman, Nira Chanu Longjam, Pearl Fernandes, Valaina Fernandes.

Indians to face tough competition at the Arctic Open Super 500

Press Trust of India
VANTAA (FINLAND)

Lakshya Sen and K. Srikanth will continue their quest for title this season as a strong Indian contingent competes at the Arctic Open Super 500 badminton tournament, beginning here on Tuesday. Lakshya faces a stern test in the first round against fifth seed Kodai Naraoka of Japan. He will need to strike a balance between aggression and restraint to tame Naraoka,

who is solid in defence and will capitalise on loose play. Srikanth opens against Rasmus Gemke. The Indian, battling inconsistency through the season, must rely on his tactical variation, net control, and mid-court transitions to keep the Dane off balance. Among India's younger players, Ayush Shetty faces top seed Kunlavut Vitidsarn of Thailand while Tharun Mannepalli will take on seventh seed Toma Junior Popov of France.

Kiran George plays Koki Watanabe of Japan while S. Sankar Muthusamy Subramanian squares off against third seed Christo Popov of France. In women's singles, Tanaya Hemanth opens against Huang Ching Ping of Chinese Taipei while Anmol Kharb meets sixth seed Lin Hsiang of Chinese Taipei. In women's doubles, Kavipriya Selvam and Simran Singh will play fifth seeds Yeung Nga Ting and Yeung Pui Lam of Hong Kong.

India off to flying start in mixed team campaign

The home team uses the substitution rule to advantage in its opener against Nepal; Unnati and Tanvi shine in their respective singles contests; Sri Lanka edges the UAE in the other Group-H tie

BADMINTON

Press Trust of India
GUWAHATI

Host India kicked off its mixed team campaign with a commanding win over Nepal, while Sri Lanka stunned the UAE in a nail-biting finish on the opening day of the BWF World Junior Championships here on Monday. India, seeded second, sailed through 45-18, 45-17 in its Group-H opener, while Sri Lanka took advantage of the changes made by the UAE to win 30-45, 45-34, 45-44.

Former champions Indonesia and South Korea, and 14-time winner China had little problem beating their respective opponents in straight sets. The mixed team championships is being played under a new best of three relay-scoring format. Each tie will be contested for the best of three sets up to 45 points, with each set comprising five matches - one each in men's singles, women's singles,



Great start: India registered a dominating victory against Nepal. ANI

men's doubles, women's doubles and mixed doubles. Teams are also allowed to change their players for each set. India took advantage of this substitution rules against Nepal. Unnati Hooda and Asian u-19 championships bronze medallist Tanvi Sharma were clinical in their respective girls singles matches, while Suryansh Rawat and Rounak Chouhan warmed up for

bigger challenges without breaking any sweat. But it was a tie between Sri Lanka and the UAE that was gripping as the former came back from a set down to win. Having lost the opening set rather easily, Sri Lanka benefitted from the UAE's decision to replace Bharath Latheesh with Riyan Malhan in boy's singles. India will meet Sri Lanka on Tuesday and then

the UAE on Wednesday.

The results (after first two session): Group B: France bt Norway 45-16, 45-24; USA bt Vietnam 45-42, 45-30; **D:** Turkiye bt Uganda 45-22, 45-22; China bt Ghana 45-14, 45-10; **E:** Chinese Taipei bt Brazil 45-24, 45-19; Denmark bt Netherlands 45-40, 45-22; **F:** Indonesia bt Philippines 45-27, 45-40; Hong Kong China bt Slovenia 45-24, 45-25; **G:** Poland bt Bhutan 45-13, 45-11; Korea bt Hungary 45-22, 45-29; **H:** India bt Nepal 45-18, 45-17; Sri Lanka bt UAE 30-45, 45-34, 45-44.

PVL: Mumbai Meteors jumps to top spot

Sports Bureau
HYDERABAD

Mumbai Meteors continued its perfect run in season four of the Prime Volleyball League, defeating Calicut Heroes 15-9, 15-8, 15-12 at the Gachibowli Indoor Stadium here on Monday. Perfectly executed tactics gave Meteors three points and a place at the top of the table. Abhinav Salar's presence helped Meteors tackle Heroes' early attacking threats. Unforced errors added to the defending champion's troubles, which its opponent capitalised on.

MRF Tyres clinches FIA ERC 2025 team championship in Croatia

Sports Bureau

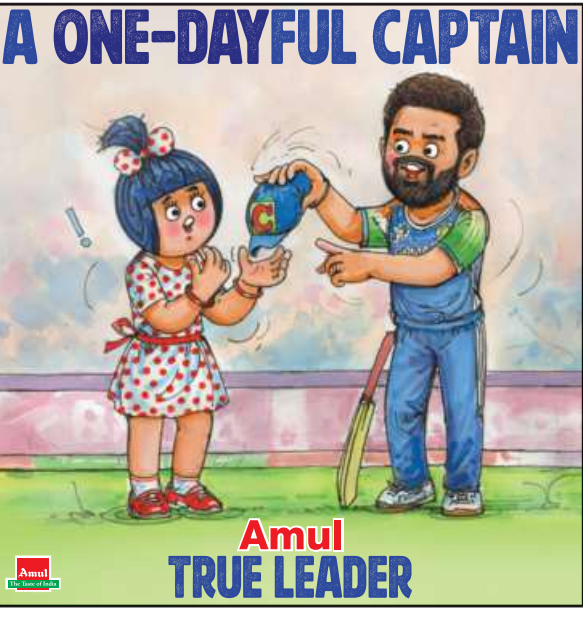
Team MRF Tyres clinched the FIA European Rally Championship (ERC) team title for the third time during the Croatia Rally in Zagreb on Sunday. Team MRF finished with 208 points, two ahead of M-Sport Ford World Rally Team. Following victories in 2022 and 2023, the ERC championship has been reclaimed by Team MRF Tyres. The 2025 season was marked by strong performances, with team victories in Hungary and Poland and a one-two finish in Sweden. At the Croatia Rally, all three Team MRF Tyres crews finished inside the



On cloud nine: The triumphant Team MRF Tyres. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

overall top-ten to clinch the title. The best result came from Lauri Juona and Kristian Temonen (Skoda Fabia RS Rally2), who finished

sixth overall. Making their debut on MRF Tyres, the Finnish crew completed all 10 special stages without issues, a strategy that paid off.



Triple delight for Pramod Bhagat

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

Ace Indian para shuttler Pramod Bhagat clinched three titles at the first Abia para badminton international tournament in Abia, Nigeria recently.

The 37-year-old won the men's singles SL3 crown with a hard-fought 21-7, 9-21, 21-9 win over compatriot Mantu Kumar in final. Bhagat then combined with Sukant Kadam to add the doubles gold, defeating Peru's Gerson Jair Vargas Lostaunaul and Diana Rojas Golac 21-13, 21-17. Bhagat's third title came in mixed doubles (SL3-SU5), where he partnered with Arati Patil. Ranjit Singh bagged bronze medals in men's singles WH1, men's doubles WH1-WH2 (with Pa-



Bhagat. X@SPORTS_ODISHA

ramjit Singh) and mixed doubles WH1-WH2 (with Shabana). Nurul Hossain Khan clinched silver in men's singles WH2, while Uma Sarkar took silver in women's singles SL3. Other notable results included bronzes for Nilesh Gaikwad (men's SL4) and Kanak Singh Jadaun (women's SL4), and a clean sweep for India in men's SU5, with Karan Paneer, Rahul Vimal and Sativada taking gold, silver, bronze .

Saini stars in Marathas' victory over Yodhas

ARCHERY PREMIER LEAGUE

Sports Bureau
NEW DELHI

Mighty Marathas defeated Prithviraj Yodhas 6-2 in the Archery Premier League at the Yamuna Sports Complex here on Monday. In wet conditions in the national capital, the Marathas began on a strong note with debutant Aman Saini striking a perfect 10. While the first two sets were won by Marathas, Yodhas struck back in the third

with a 75-72 win. The former bounced back strongly in the fourth and final set. On Sunday, Prithviraj Yodhas had defeated Chero Archers in a shoot-off while Rajputana Royals continued their good run with a 6-2 victory against Kakatiya Knights. For the Yodhas, Abhish-ek Verma proved his class in the shoot-off by hitting a perfect 10 to give his team an early lead. Gatha Anandrao followed up with another one, eventually helping the Yodhas seal victory.

ODISHA STATE SEEDS CORPORATION LIMITED
(A GOVERNMENT UNDERTAKING)
SANTARAPUR, BHUBANESWAR- 751002.
Tel-MD 0674- 2340573, E-Mail: mdosscltd456@gmail.com
NIT No.OSSC/Mktg(Hort)-49/2025
Short e-Tender Call Notice for Procurement of Certified Chillii Seeds for Rabi - 2025-26

OSSC Ltd. invites short e-Tender only from registered Chillii seed producers (and in case of GOI PSUs, their authorized Agencies) on item wise rate contract basis for **Procurement of Certified Chillii Seeds for Rabi-2025-26** in double cover system through online mode only for the work below.

Name of the work	Purchase of Certified Chillii Seeds for Rabi-2025-26.
No of work	One
Availability of bid documents in portal	15.00 hours on dt. 08.10.2025 to 17.00 hrs of dt.17.10.2025
Last date of receipt of tender in portal	17.00 hrs of dt.17.10.2025
Date and time of Opening of Bid	10.30 hrs of dt.18.10.2025

The detailed descriptions of crops, varieties, quantity, parameters, terms and conditions and other details of tender specified in the tender schedule would be made available in the e-Tender portal www.tendersodisha.gov.in. Any addendum/corrigendum/ cancellation can also be seen in the said website.

CAD-1939: Sd/- Managing Director, OSSC Ltd. OIPR-01045/11/0106/2526

CSIR-Indian Institute of Chemical Biology
4, Raja S.C. Mullick Road, Jadavpur, Kolkata-700032
SHORT TENDER NOTICE

1.Name of work: Repair & Renovation of Different rooms (Civil, Electrical & Air Condition work) at CSIR-IICB, Kolkata.; 2). Estimated Cost 1,41,42,000/-; 3). E-Tender No. 2025_CSIR_251233_1; 4). Publication date in C.P.P. portal —06.10.2025; 5). For further details please visit <https://www.iicb.res.in/tenders>, and <https://etenders.gov.in>/eprocure/app.

OFFICE OF THE ROURKELA MUNICIPAL CORPORATION
Udit Nagar, Rourkela, Dist.: - Sundargarh (Odisha) Pin - 769012
Website : www.rmc.nic.in, Email Id : rourkelamunicipality@gmail.com

No. 11598 **TENDER CALL NOTICE** Date: 04/10/2025

Sealed tenders are invited from the reputed firms /Agencies for "Engagement of Manpower for Maintenance & Cleaning of Sewerage Line & Pit of Koelnagar on Outsource Basis".

Detail technical specifications, along with terms & conditions etc., may be seen from the Web site of Rourkela Municipal Corporation i.e. www.rmc.nic.in. Date of issue of tender documents from dtd **06.10.2025**

The last date for receipt of sealed tender is **20.10.2025 till 01.00 P.M.** through Speed Post/ Regd. Post/ Courier/ or by hand in the office address of the undersigned.

Commissioner,
Rourkela Municipal Corporation
C-1216: OIPR-13131/11/0170/2526

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER,
RURAL WORKS CIRCLE, BOLANGIR.
e - Procurement NOTICE

1. Name of Work	Construction of Weir Adjacent to Bridge in the district of Bolangir for the year 2025-26
2. No. of Work	2 (Two)
3. Time for Completion	4 (Four) Calendar Months
4. Approximate Estimated Cost varies from	Rs.148.96 lakhs to Rs.230.36 lakhs
5. Mode of Submission of tender	Tender should be submitted online in www.tendersodisha.gov.in
6. Other details are as follow	

Procurement Officer	Bid Identification No.	Availability of Tender on-line for bidding	Last Date & Time of seeking tender clarification	Date & Time of opening of tender
Chief Construction Engineer, R.W. Circle, Bolangir.	BLGR-Online-20/2025-26	08.10.2025 upto 11.00 A.M.	22.10.2025 upto 5.00 P.M.	20.10.2025 upto 5.00 P.M.
				23.10.2025 11.00 A.M.

The date will be intimated later on

• Further details can be seen from the website www.tendersodisha.gov.in
• Any Corrigendum/Addendum will be displayed in the above e tender website only.

Chief Construction Engineer, R.W.Circle, Bolangir
O-907: OIPR-25118/11/0063/2526

डॉ हरिसिंह गौर विश्वविद्यालय, सागर (म.प्र.)
Dr. Harisingh Gour Vishwavidyalaya, Sagar (M.P.)
"A Central University" | A+ Grade by NAAC (Fourth Cycle)
Ref. No. /DoFA/PE/GF/2025/281 29/09/2025

Walk-In Interview

Department of Physical Education

Applications are invited for the engagement of guest faculty (per lecture basis) in 01 discipline in the Department of Physical Education of the university. Applicants are advised to visit the Website Link <https://dhsgsu.edu.in/recruitment> for the detailed advertisement and application form.

Date of interview: 14-10-2025
Time of interview: 12.00 PM
Venue of interview: Gour Samiti Kaksh, Main Administrative Building Dr. Harisingh Gour University, Sagar

Website link: <https://dhsgsu.edu.in/recruitment> **Registrar**



The journey hasn't been smooth for SatChi as they have had to deal with personal issues and injuries this season; the return of Tan Kim has given them renewed hope

S ND-ND

*Kirigami
parachutes
land on target*

S ND-NDE